

ARCHAEOLOGICAL SURVEY OF MINE LANDS IN THE
RATON COAL FIELD FOR THE
ABANDONED MINE LAND BUREAU

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LABORATORY OF ANTHROPOLOGY NOTE NO. 386

Santa Fe

1987

New Mexico

ADMINISTRATIVE SUMMARY

The Research Section, Laboratory of Anthropology, conducted an archaeological clearance survey for the Abandoned Mine Land Bureau, New Mexico Department of Energy and Minerals, at 18 coal mine sites, 1 waste pond, and 3 gob piles within the Raton coal field in Colfax County, New Mexico. The clearance survey covered .52 square km (128 acres).

Mine openings are located primarily on the Maxwell Land Grant north of U.S. 64 between Cimarron and Raton and east of Raton off of State Road 72 near Yankee, New Mexico. These include mine features at the now-abandoned mining communities of Koehler, Blossburg, Van Houten, and Brilliant. The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to completely backfill or dynamite adit openings, divert a drainage adjacent to a gob pile, and construct new water channels at the waste pond.

Cultural resources were recorded at 15 mine sites. These include mine adits, fan houses, air courses, a winding house, tram supports, load-outs, a railroad trestle, cisterns, and numerous associated collapsed structures and foundations. Eleven mine locations and their associated features are designated as sites.

Cultural resource clearance is therefore recommended for all surveyed mine openings, gob piles and water channels. Cultural features can be avoided at all sites except for those at the Talbot Mine (LA 57197), and several at Van Houten. Structures at the Talbot Mine which are in extreme disrepair and a hazard to livestock and are recommended for demolition. Several structures at Van Houten are in imminent danger of collapsed and are recommended for dismantling.

Submitted in fulfillment of the terms of the Joint Powers Agreement (JPA # 1-74-79) between the Energy and Minerals Department and the Museum of New Mexico.

Museum of New Mexico Project No. 41.392

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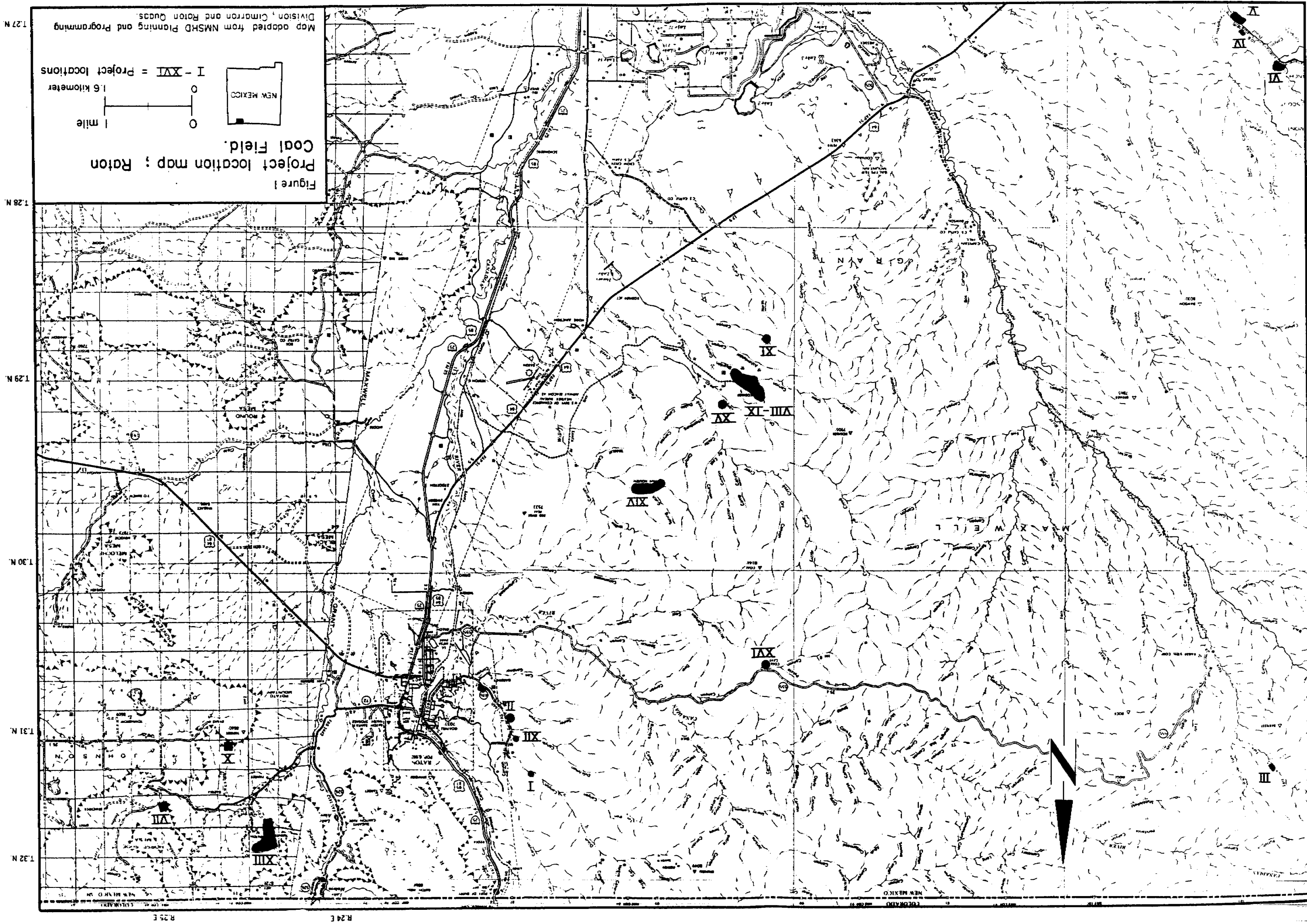
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INTRODUCTION

The Research Section of the Laboratory of Anthropology, Museum of New Mexico, conducted an archaeological clearance survey at 18 coal mine locations within the Raton Coal Field from November 17 to November 20, 1986, and on February 10, 1987. The survey was conducted at the request of Robert Salter of the Abandoned Mine Land Bureau, New Mexico Department of Energy and Minerals, in order to determine the nature and significance of possible cultural resources within the project area. The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to mechanically and hand fill, seal, or collapse by blasting, the existing mine openings and cisterns. At two sites, water channels will be redirected to alleviate problems with waste material. The mine openings present a safety hazard to local citizens, hunters, and hikers. This report identifies cultural remains located within the project area and provides clearance recommendations for avoiding adverse impact to the resources due to mine closing activities.

The Raton project area (Fig. 1) is located on private land within and adjacent to the Maxwell Land Grant, Colfax County, New Mexico. The total area surveyed was .52 square km (128 acres). Exact areas surveyed are shown on individual project maps.

This project complies with the provisions of the National Historic Preservation Act of 1966, as amended, and its implementing regulations. The purpose of this clearance inventory is to identify cultural resources that may be affected by the undertaking of the Abandoned Mine Land Bureau and to gather sufficient information to evaluate the eligibility of these properties to the National Register of Historic Places, as required by 36 CFR 800.4 (b). The Office of Surface Mining serves as lead federal agency for NHPA compliance.



ENVIRONMENT

The project area lies within the Southern Rocky Mountain physiographic province in the region called the Park Plateau. It is characterized by high mountains and wooded areas ranging in elevation from 7,000 to 12,491 ft (2133 to 3807 m). The topography is rough and broken with steep slopes and canyons dissected by small rivers and streams which drain into the Canadian River. Other major drainages in the area are the Vermejo and Cimarron rivers. Small mountain valleys are numerous. Near Raton is a wide area of high basalt-capped mesas edged with steep escarpments and cliffs (Maker et al. 1972:5-7). The most prominent of these is Johnson Mesa.

Temperatures in the region are generally cool. The variance in elevations causes the mean annual maximum temperature to range from 55 degrees F to 68 degrees F (12.7 to 20.0 degrees C). Temperature variation is also a result of slope exposure and air drainage. At Cimarron there is a mean of 157 frost-free days, while at Raton the mean is 134 days with variations inversely related to elevation.

The area has a low relative humidity. Precipitation occurs mostly in the summer from frontal systems arising in the Gulf of Mexico. Winters are generally dry; however, there can be heavy snow accumulations in the higher elevations. The average annual precipitation is 15-16 inches (37.5 to 40.0 cm) with greater amounts in the higher mountains.

In the valley bottoms and rolling uplands, soils are formed in weathering shale and limestone. The soils are used mostly for the grazing of livestock and wildlife. The area supports a fair to good cover of native vegetation including alkali sacaton (Sporobolus airoides), western wheatgrass (Agropyron smithii), blue grama (Bouteloua gracilis), galleta (Hilaria jamesii), sideoats grama (Bouteloua curtipendula), buffalograss (Buchloe dactyloides), and mat muhly (Muhlenbergia richardsonis) (Maker et al. 1972:14).

On the steep slopes and escarpments are numerous shrubs and woody species including oak (Quercus spp.), mountain mahogany (Cercocarpus montanus), pinyon (Pinus edulis), juniper (Juniperus monosperma), and some ponderosa pine (Pinus ponderosa; Maker et al 1972:33).

Fauna of the region is plentiful and includes black-tailed jackrabbit (Lepus americanus), ground squirrel (Citellus sp.), Botta's pocket gopher (Thomomys bottae), pocket mouse (Perognathus sp.), raccoon (Procyon lotor), western spotted skunk (Spilogale gracilis), pronghorn antelope (Antilocapra americana), gray fox (Urocyon cinerargenteus), black bear (Ursus americanus), badger (Taxidea taxus), elk (Cervus elaphus), mule deer (Odocoileus hermionus), white-tailed deer (Odocoileus virginianus), mountain lion (Felis concolor), wild turkey (Melagris gallopavo), bobcat (Felis rufus), and coyote (Canis latrans).

Other species include black-billed magpie (Pica pica), western kingbird (Tyrannus verticalis), gray jay (Perisoreus canadensis), scaled quail (Callipepla squamata), various hawks (Accipiter sp.), cutthroat trout (Salmo clarki), prairie rattlesnake (Crotalus viridis), and numerous geese, ducks, lizards, toads, and snakes (Martin 1976:97-102).

Grizzly bear (Ursus horribilis) were common in the valleys and canyons of the mountains in the mid-1800s. By the late nineteenth century, wolves were prevalent while the presence of grizzly bears, mountain lions, and coyotes decreased. Today deer are common in the foothills and pronghorn antelope range in the surrounding prairies (Murphy 1969:81).

BRIEF CULTURE HISTORY OF THE REGION

Although the lack of in-depth archaeological work and difficulty in sorting out cultural identifications in northeastern New Mexico has been noted (Stuart and Gauthier 1981:291), recently there has been an increasing concentration of archaeological studies in this area. The most extensive work to date has been the survey and excavations by the York Canyon Archaeological Project (1975 to 1984) on Kaiser Steel Corporation and Vermejo Park lands within the Maxwell Land Grant. Also on the Maxwell Land Grant, Oakes has completed the excavation of a portion of the early community of Colfax (1983), while Merlan (1975) has examined the mining town of Catskill. Mining activities at Sargarite have been documented by Horvath (1985). MacGillivray and Truter (1978) conducted an archaeological survey along the York Canyon Road. The Vermejo River has been surveyed from Colfax north to the mouth of York Canyon by Glassow. Glassow (1980) has also developed a cultural classification system for the area based mainly on diagnostic artifacts. Numerous surveys of the region have also been conducted by Gunnerson (1959, 1968, 1969). The Philmont Scout Ranch near Cimarron has also conducted fieldwork on its extensive holdings since 1941. Immediately east of the study area is the Folsom Site, where evidence of Early Man was in New Mexico first discovered (Wormington 1957).

A computer analysis was conducted by the Archaeological Records Management System, Historic Preservation Division, Santa Fe, to identify cultural resources within the vicinity of the various project locations. A total of 158 sites were identified and tabulated (Table 1). Most are historic sites (41%) associated with the Maxwell Land Grant; however, some of these may represent Apache or Ute sites. There is a good representation of various prehistoric sites also.

Table 1. Sites in the project vicinity

<u>Period</u>	<u>No</u>
PaleoIndian	1
Archaic/Unknown lithic	9
Basketmaker III	2
Pueblo II-V	32
Plains Indian	1
Historic, 1821-1912	21
Historic, 1912-present	8
Historic, unknown	36
<u>Unknown</u>	<u>48</u>
Total	158

Occupation of the project area during the Paleoindian period (ca. 10,000 to 7,000 B.C.) is known from the Folsom Site discovered in 1908,

where faunal remains of extinct Bison antiquus were found with Early Man Folsom projectile points dating to ca 9200 B.C. Many more Paleoindian points have been recovered by local residents in the entire northeastern New Mexico region. Other Paleoindian sites include the Pigeon Cliffs Shelter near Clayton (Steen 1955), along the Dry Cimarron River (Baker and Campbell 1960), near Van Bremmer Canyon (Kirkpartick 1976) and in Ancho and Potato canyons (York Canyon Archaeological Project, 1984). There may be many Paleoindian sites in this area; however, they are presently not identifiable without the presence of the characteristic projectile points typically used for big-game hunting.

The Archaic period (ca. 7,000 B.C. to A.D. 400) is broadly defined. Whereas Paleoindians are considered to be primarily hunters, Archaic peoples are thought to be more dependent on foraging. Several rock shelters in the region that belong to the Archaic period include Pigeon Cliff, (Steen 1955) and several in the Dry Cimarron (Hall 1938). The Late Archaic period corresponds to what has also been identified as early Plains Woodland or Panhandle Aspect (Campbell 1976).

The Pueblo period (A.D. 400 to 1350) is characterized by a dependence on agriculture and a sedentary lifestyle. Numerous rockshelters in Ponil Canyon have been dated to this period (Lutes 1959). Glassow (1980) has identified 304 Pueblo period sites along many of the rivers and streams in the northeastern area. Ceramics from this time are generally brown wares. Late in the period neckbanded and incised gray wares appear, along with Taos Black-on-white and utility wares.

The area was frequented often during the Protohistoric period (A.D. 1350 to 1600) by various Plains groups to the east. Gunnerson (1969) has recorded several Apache sites with adobe architecture and use of Pueblo pottery. The first historical accounting of Plains groups dates from the Coronado expedition of 1540 to 1542. Jicarilla Apaches are known to have occupied the area until 1884 when they were relocated to a reservation near Tierra Amarilla.

During the seventeenth century, the area was frequented by individual prospectors, missionaries, and Indian traders. It was a buffer zone for Spanish and French fur traders during the eighteenth century. By the nineteenth century, the area was a popular source of beaver skins. In 1821 the mountain branch of the Santa Fe Trail passed through the area. The trail was in operation until the late 1870s when the railroad entered the region.

Land in the project area is within the Maxwell Land Grant which was established in 1841. Gold was discovered in the western part of the grant in 1866 and created a gold rush with the resulting rise of the community of Elizabethtown. The grant sold in 1870 and unrest between former settlers and new owners developed into the Colfax County War in 1875. The character of land-use changed from private ranching concerns and localized gold mining to one of big business involvement and land speculation.

Raton was originally named Willow Springs and was first established as a railroad camp in 1879; by 1881, it was the county seat. Coal mining developed in the 1880s with many coal mine communities established both on and off the grant.

The high altitude of the region limits the type of crops that can be grown, such as alfalfa and hay. However, much of the land grant is suited to cattle grazing and there are numerous large cattle ranches still in existence.

SURVEY METHODS AND RESULTS

From November 17 to November 20, 1986, and on February 10, 1987 Research Section archaeologists, Yvonne Oakes and Dorothy Zamora assisted by Denise Solano of the New Mexico Energy and Minerals Department, surveyed the project area for cultural resources. All mine openings to be closed or altered by the Abandoned Mine Land Bureau were located and recorded. The terrain surrounding each feature, including procurement areas for fill and access roads, was also surveyed by walking in 10 m zig-zag transects until 100 percent coverage of the project area was reached. All cultural resources located on the survey were photographed and recorded, and a plan map was drawn to scale; no collections were made.

All mine features received an identification number assigned by the Abandoned Mine Land Bureau which is used throughout this report. Records at the Archaeological Records Management System, Historic Preservation Division, Santa Fe, were consulted prior to the field work to identify sites located near or within the project area.

Eighteen coal mine openings, 1 waste pond and 3 gob piles were examined within the project area. For this report, mine openings are defined as adits or shafts which are horizontal or vertical passages into mine workings. A gob pile is waste coal left from old workings. Cultural resources were recorded at 15 of the mine sites and were given site designations. Mine openings or waste piles that had no associated features or structural remains were not given site designations. No prehistoric use of the mine areas was noted.

SITE DESCRIPTIONS

I-Swastika No. 1 Mine

Location: UTM Zone 13, XXXXXX, XXXXXXXX N.

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, 1960.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: This is a concrete-surrounded abandoned shaft located 10 m east of the Dillon Canyon Road at the base of low foothills. It measures 51.8 m deep with a 3.6 by 2.4 m roofed concrete surround (Fig. 2). An opening exists in the roof. There is a 4.5 by 4.5 m hogwire fence around the enclosure. No artifacts are present near the shaft.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to completely backfill the shaft with dirt from the borrow area located directly west of the shaft across the Dillon Canyon Road. The area of 60.0 by 60.0 m was surveyed and archaeologically cleared by Research Section personnel.

II-Blossburg Cisterns A and B (LA 57193)

Location A: UTM Zone [REDACTED] [REDACTED] N

Location B: UTM Zone 13, [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, ca. 1898 to 1902.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: Two open cisterns are located 2.0 km apart along the Dillon Canyon Road. They are situated in open fields and surrounded by tall grasses. Both are associated with historic structural foundations that were part of the mining community of Blossburg.

Cistern A is a vertical hole 2.0 by 1.0 m wide dug 12.0 m into the ground. The opening is stone-lined in its upper reaches. A rusted car door and stove part lie near the opening. In the field surrounding the cistern are numerous structural foundations with light scatters of trash (Fig. 4). These are not visible from the main road, but are hidden from view by tall grasses.

Cistern B is also a vertical, stone-lined hole measuring 2.0 by 1.0 m and dug over 30.0 m into the ground (Fig. 3). Historic trash and structural foundations are also situated in the open field near the cistern (Fig. 4).

Historic trash in both fields consists of aqua and purple glass,

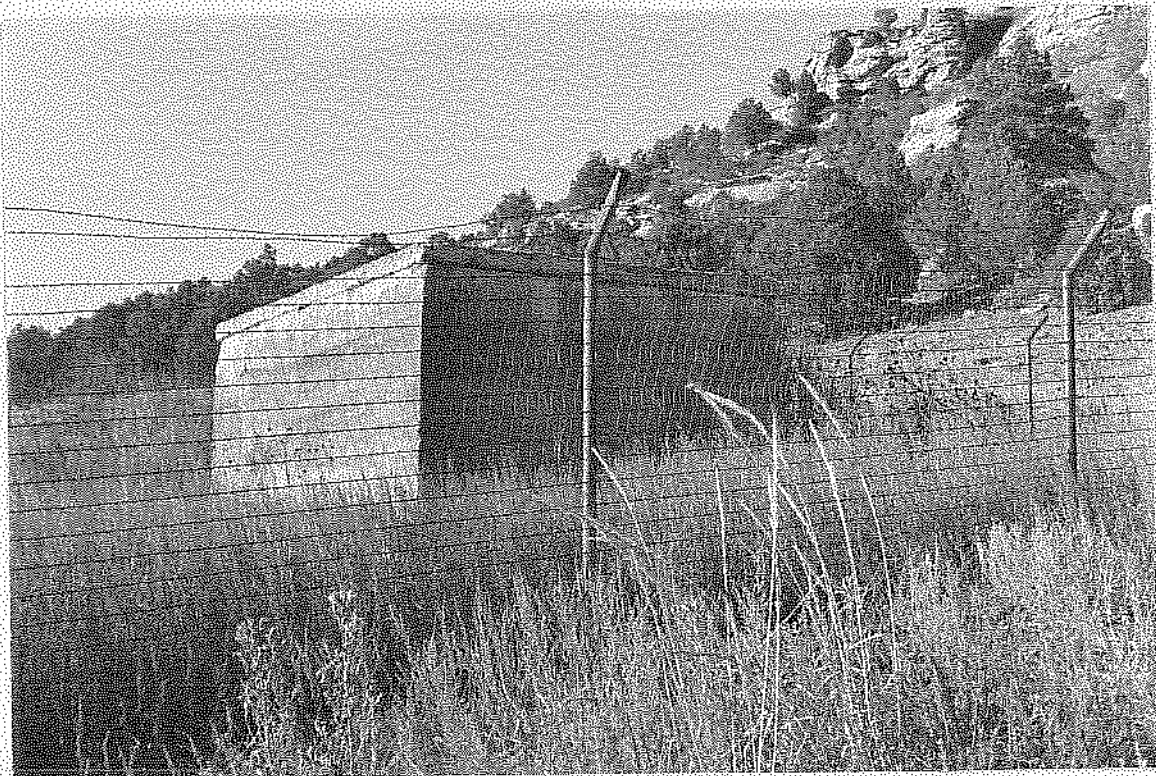


FIG. 2. Swastika Mine opening, facing north.



FIG. 3. Blossburg Cistern B, in open field.

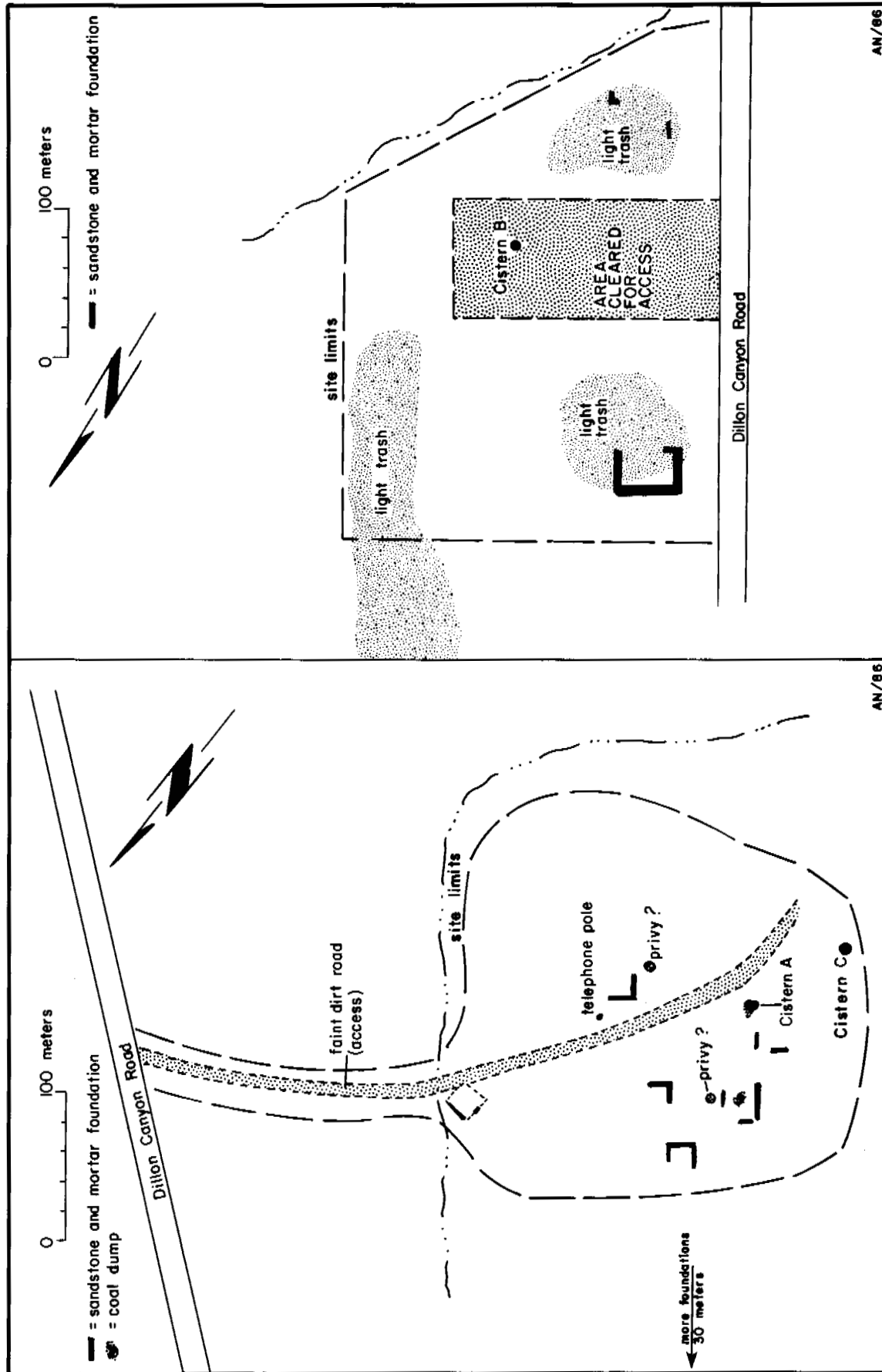


Figure 4. Blossburg Cisterns A, B and C, plan views.

and fragments of ironware. All foundations consist of a sandstone and mortar base. There are no standing walls.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to completely backfill both cisterns. The access to them has been cleared by Research Section archaeologists (Fig. 4).

III-Upper York Canyon Prospect

Location: UTM Zone 13, XXXXX, XXXXX N.

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, 1968 to mid-1970s.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: The site consists of a waste coal pile covering a steep slope 45.0 m high. At the base of the slope is an open parking area of 75.0 by 25.0 m located immediately adjacent to the Upper York Canyon Road. A few posts from a removed load-out remain on the slope.

Sediment and coal from the steep waste pile are being carried into York Canyon Creek which flows into the Vermejo River approximately 17.5 km downstream. Brook stickleback (*Culaea inconstans*) inhabit the Vermejo River and no other drainage system in New Mexico. Further sedimentation and detriment to this drainage may result in a loss of habitat for the Brook stickleback or injury to the fish.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to construct a berm on a bench above the coal waste to prevent sediments from being carried downslope to the creek. Two rip-rap channels will be constructed to provide a controlled means for water movement. The site will also be seeded and mulched.

IV-Luckini No. 1 Mine

Location: UTM Zone 13, XXXXX, XXXXX N.

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, ca. 1933 to 1950.

Ownership: Private, Chase Ranch.

Description: This is a partially open adit located on a steep slope 50.0 m above the junction of Chase and Ponil canyons. The adit has been dug into the sandstone bedrock. The opening of 2.5 by 1.3 m has not been framed, but several posts can be seen in the interior. A crude wood post retaining wall is situated 6 m in front and downslope from the adit. Coal waste covers the slope below the adit.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to further collapse the opening or backfill it with fallen rock from the site. This will be done by hand.

V-Vellar Mine (LA 57194)

Location: UTM Zone 13, [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, ca. 1933 to 1950.

Ownership: Private, Chase Ranch.

Description: The site consists of an adit located on a bench on the side of a steep hill. It is built into the sandstone bedrock and has a timbered opening which measures 2.6 by 1.25 m (Fig. 7). The supports are cut from unpeeled pine trees with the lintel laid over the slightly notched posts. More support posts extend into the adit for at least 15.0 m and are spaced 1.5 m apart. Wire nails protrude from the posts.

A tailings pile is located downslope from the adit. Extending ca. 25.0 m from the bench to the base of the hill are the remains of a load-out (Fig. 5). It is constructed from 8 inch unpeeled logs and fastened with wire nails. Side boards are 2 by 10 inches. There is a metal gate at the base of the load-out which slides up and down by means of an attached rope. The gate measures .82 by .53 m. The load-out has collapsed tin roofing with an embossed circular design.

Five meters in front of the load-out is a small shed measuring 2.0 by 1.35 m and 1.45 m high. It is board and batten of 1 by 6 inch boards. It has a sloping wood roof covered with asphalt paper. There is a small two-paned window on the west side which is .61 by .28 m. The east side of the shed is open. Scattered around the flat area at the base of the load-out are a pile of lumber, and small trash areas containing sanitary cans, beer cans, crockery fragments, and pieces of metal. An abandoned road leads east through an open field to an entry gate in a barbed wire fence.

Twenty-five meters downslope from the load-out and shed is the depression of a pit structure located among the pinyon trees at the base of the hill. It likely represents the remains of a dugout and measures 6.0 m wide by 4.9 m long. A patch of non-native iris is growing on one side of the depression. The dugout faces southeast with a small trash pile in front consisting of aqua window glass, fragments of metal cans, wire nails, and ironstone.

Five meters downslope from the dugout depression is a dry-laid collapsed rock structure of sandstone (Fig. 6). It measures 4.0 by 3.6 m with standing walls of 1.3 m height. The roofing has collapsed, but thin timber poles and tin roofing remain. Light trash of broken glass and ironstone are located behind the structure which has been dug into a low bank.

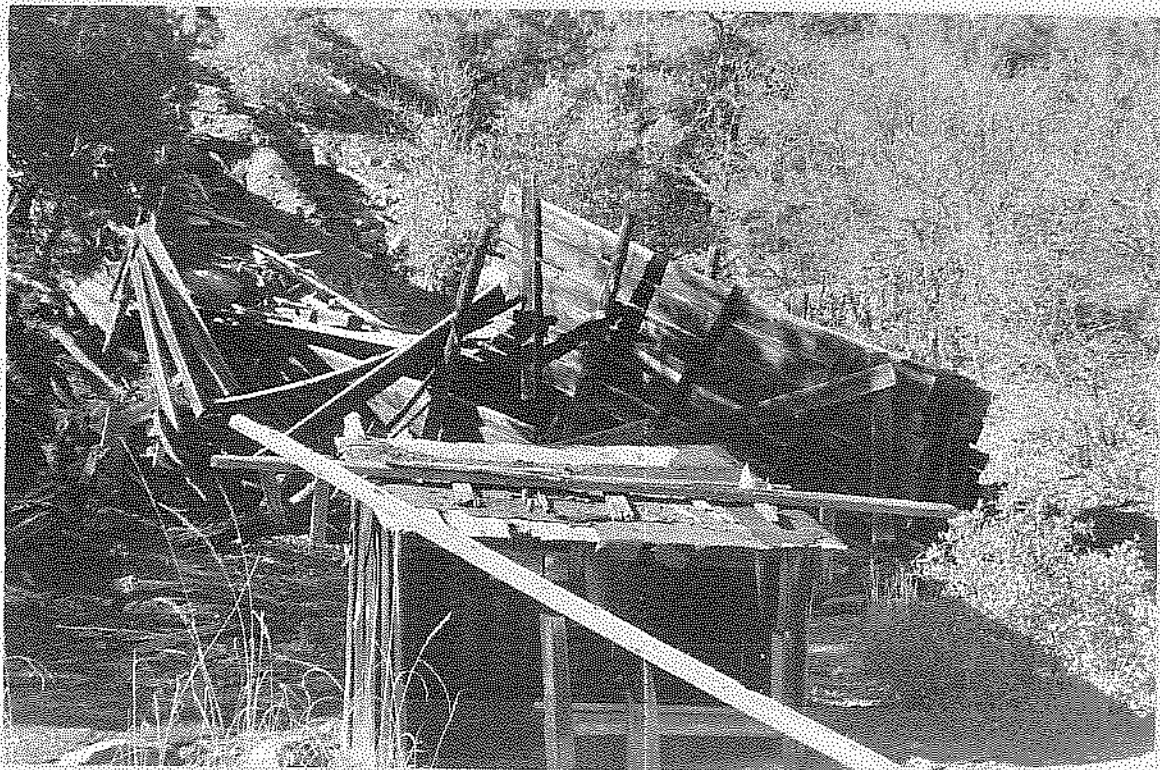


FIG. 5. Load-out and shed and Vellar Mine.

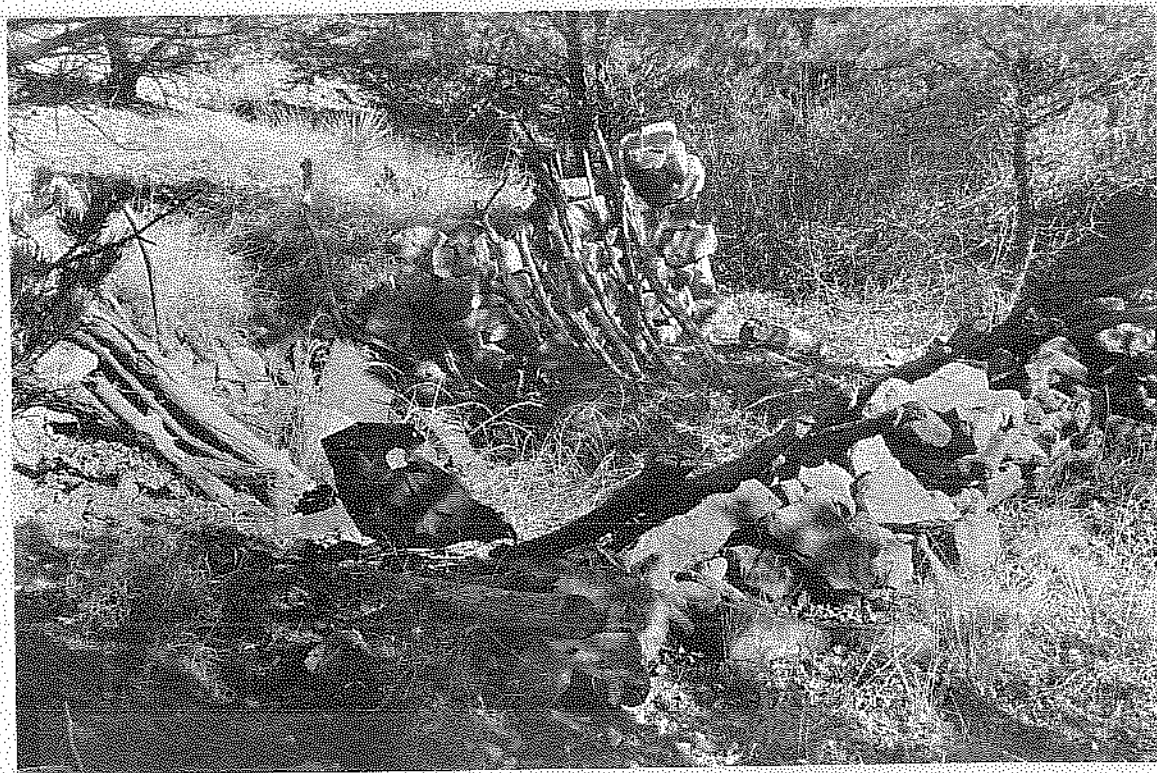


FIG. 6. Rock structure with collapsed pole roof.

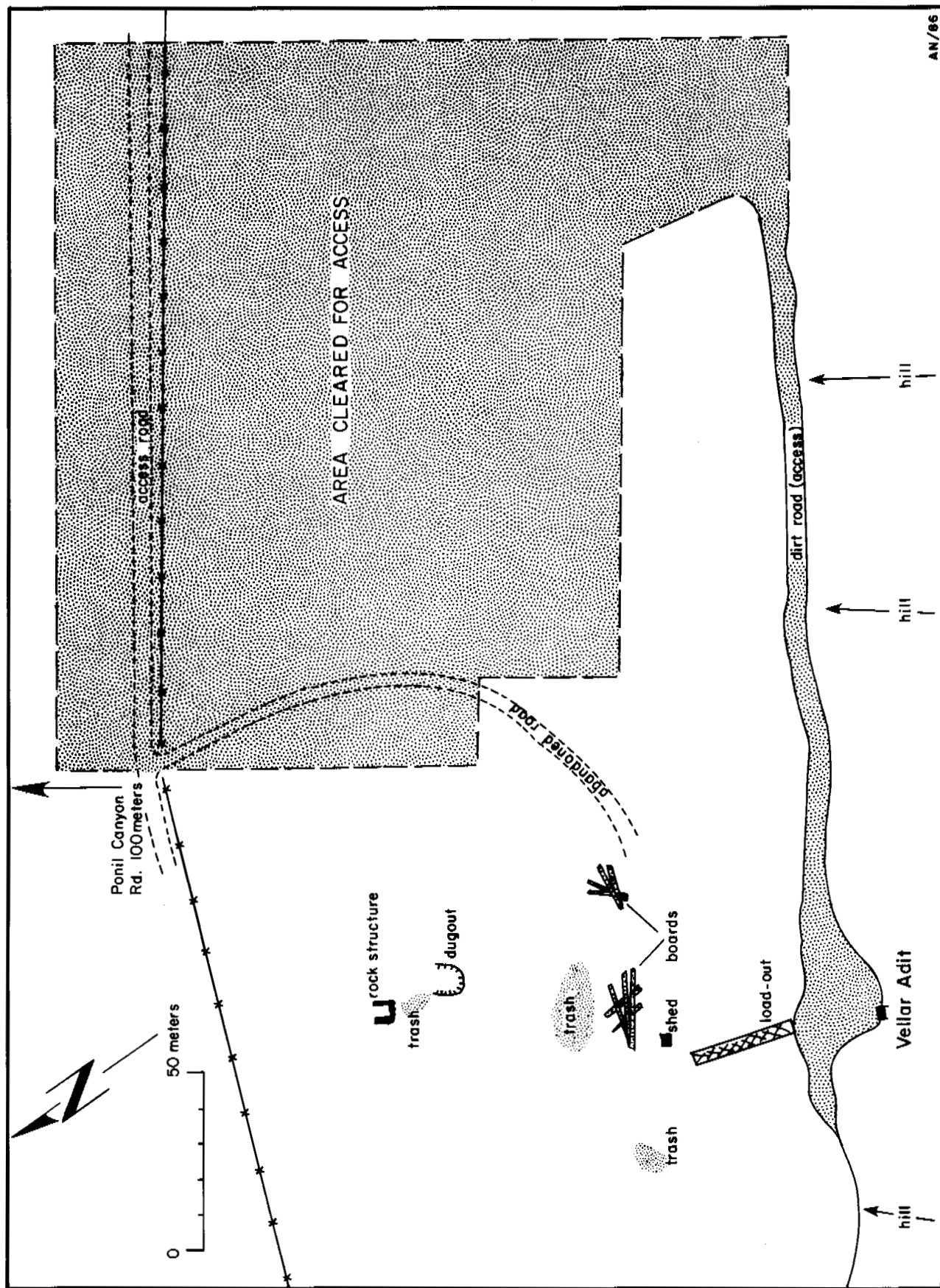


Figure 7. Plan view of Vellar mine.

There is an access route through the entry gate, across the open field and over an abandoned dirt road which then climbs the bench leading to the adit (Fig. 7). The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to close the adit with a re-enforced concrete closure. Research Section archaeologists have cleared the access route through the open field and along the bench. Mine personnel will not impact the structural remains at the base of the hill.

VI-Roadside Adit

Location: UTM Zone 1 [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, unknown.

Ownership: Private, Philmont Scout Ranch.

Description: This is an open prospect dug into the sandstone bedrock of a steep cliff immediately adjacent to the Ponil Canyon Road. It has not been framed and measures 2 m wide by .75 m high. It extends into the rock for 3 m. No cultural material is located near the adit.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to completely backfill the adit with native stone lying near the opening.

VII-Genta Mine (LA 57195)

Location: UTM Zone 13, XXXXX, XXXXX N.

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, 1934 to 1971.

Ownership: Private, Fay Leighton.

Description: The site consists of two adits cut into the bank of a hill with associated structures. One adit was timbered but has now mostly collapsed. There is a wood post retaining wall associated with the adit. The other adit sits 20.0 m to the north and is part of a fan house structure which measures 3.0 by 5.0 m. Walls of the fan house are poured concrete.

Five meters north of the fan house is a collapsed frame structure 4.0 by 6.0 m which may once have served as a shed. Pieces of large mine machinery are located between the fan house and the first adit. Railroad tracks lead from this adit to a load-out which extends downslope from the adit for 20.0 m to a leveled area (Figs. 8 and 9). The load-out is supported on 12 by 14 inch round posts and framed with 2 by 10 inch boards. It is fastened with machinery bolts and wire nails. Several wooden coal carts lie abandoned on the slopes of the hill which is also covered with coal. An access road leads to the

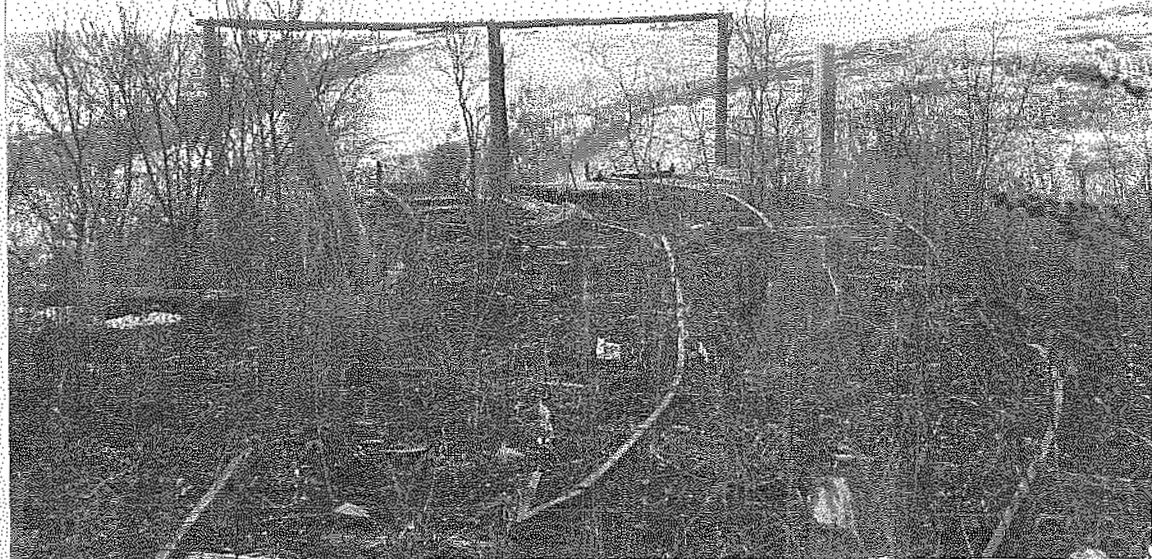


FIG. 8. Railroad tracks leading to load-out at Genta Mine.



FIG. 9. Load-out at Genta Mine.

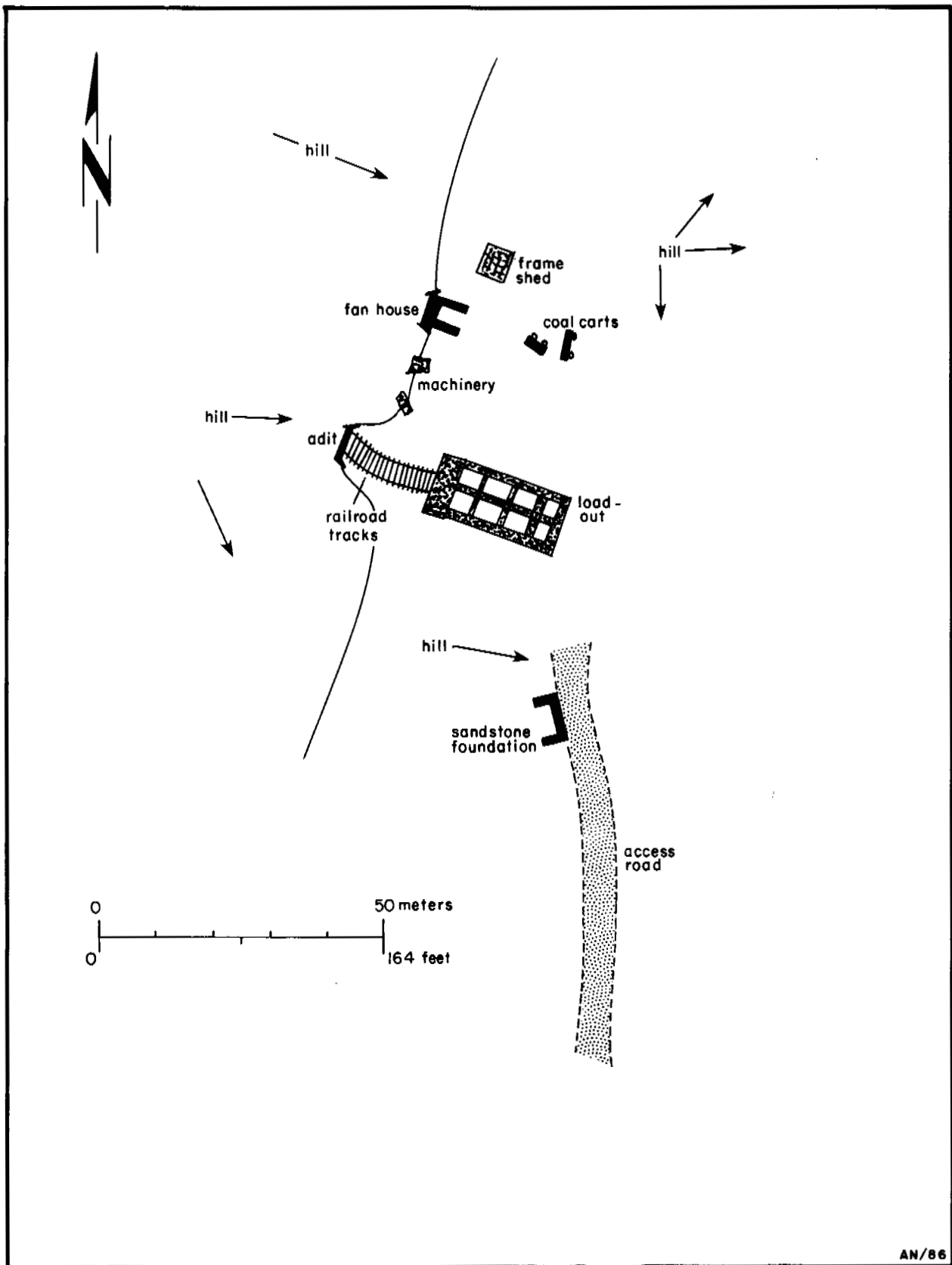


Figure 10. Plan view of Genta Mine.

clearing at the base of the load-out. Along this road is a concrete structural foundation measuring 8 by 4 m which is partially covered with soil washing downhill.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to completely collapse the first adit opening by hand and to install a concrete closure over the adit associated with the fan house (Fig. 10). Research Section archaeologists have cleared the access road into the site and have been assured by Abandoned Mine Land personnel that site structures and cultural material will not be disturbed.

VIII-Koehler Mines (LA 57196)

Location: UTM Zone 13



Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, 1907-1954.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: The Koehler mines are an integral part of the larger coal-mining community of Koehler (LA 57196). Only a portion of the mines on the site have been archaeologically surveyed (Fig. 11). These include an adit within a fan house and an associated winding house and railroad bed. In an adjacent canyon are five more adits, one with a nearby structure. Access to the mines is north off U.S. 64 on the Praire Crow Canyon Road through locked gates.

The fan and winding houses are known as Old Koehler No. 1 Mine. These structures are situated on a knoll which sits 10.0 m above the narrow canyon. Across the canyon, ca. 150.0 m to the south, are the abandoned structures of the more recent Koehler Mine. These were not surveyed and will not be affected by current mine closing activities. The adit at Old Koehler No. 1 Mine is located high on the slope above the canyon and inside a fan house (Fig. 12). The fan house measures 3.5 m wide and is 2.3 m high, it is constructed of sandstone block with a low pitched roof covered with wood and asphalt. The front entry is a large wood slat door painted red. Directly inside the door is an immense fan once used to direct air down the adit opening which sits 6.8 m inside of the fan house. The adit opening measures 2.7 by 1.7 m and is framed with peeled logs. Log supports also extend at least 20.0 m back into the adit. No artifacts were found near the fan house.

A winding house is situated 35.0 m downslope from the fan house (Fig. 13). It is also of sandstone block with a pitched roof of wood and asphalt. The structure measures 11.3 by 4.3 m and is ca. 2.5 high. Walls are 45.0 cm thick. The roof has partially collapsed; however, the 2 by 10 inch cross beams are intact. A metal beam above the front entry is stamped "Pat. 1915" indicating that the structure

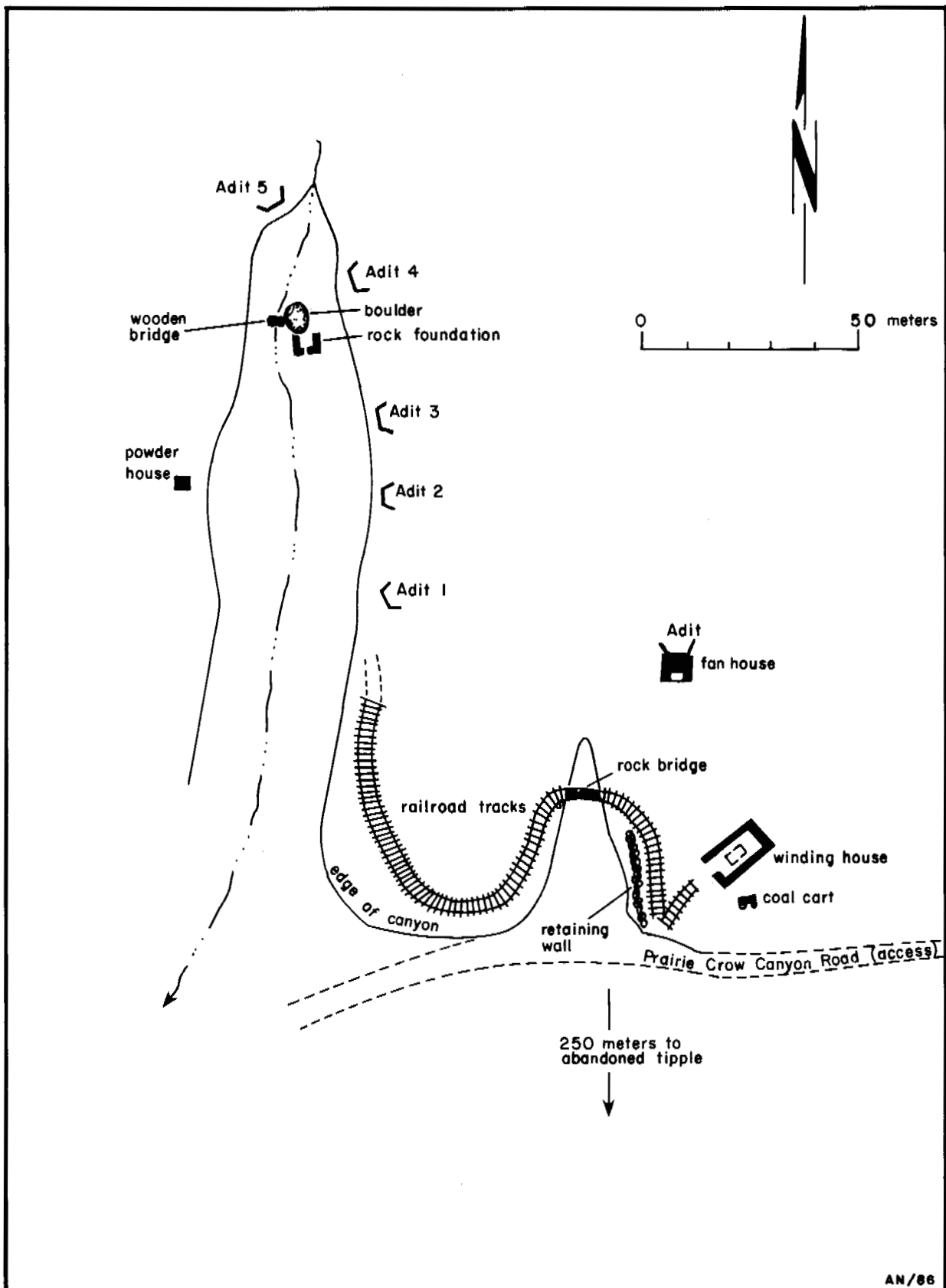


Figure II. Plan view of Old Koehler Mine.

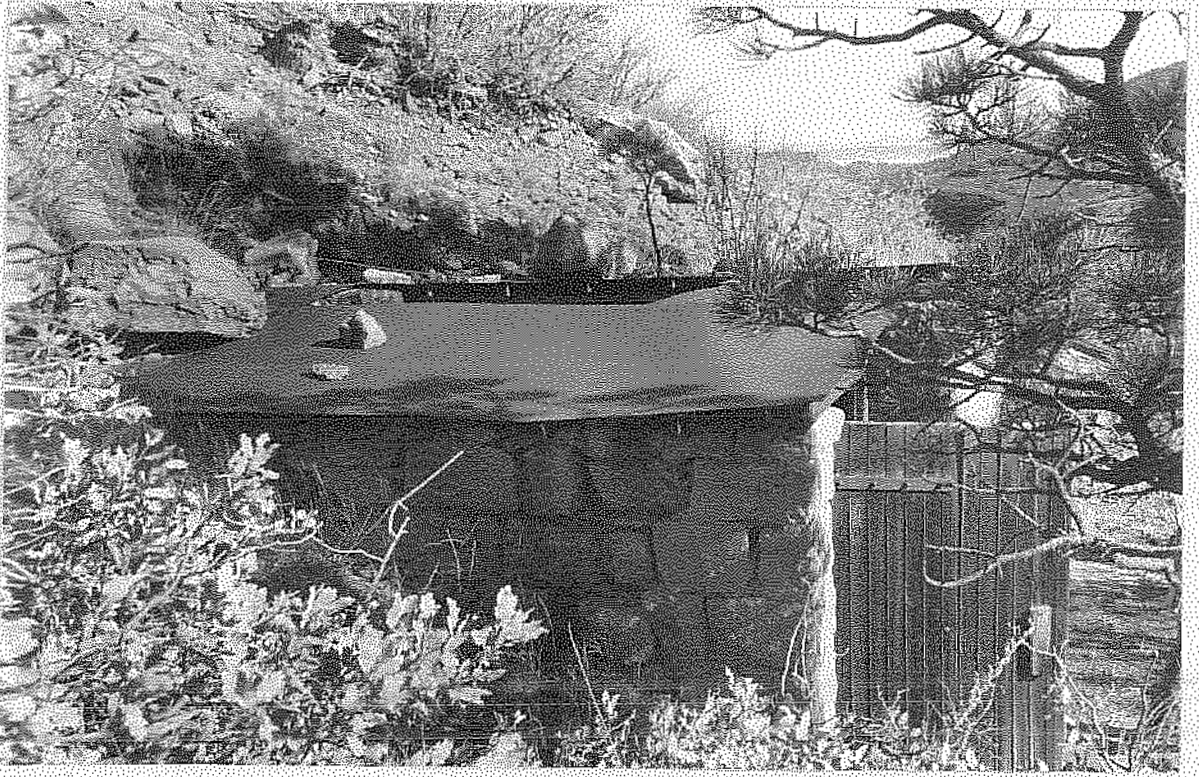


FIG. 12. Old Koehler Mine No. 1 fan house.
Adit is inside of structure.

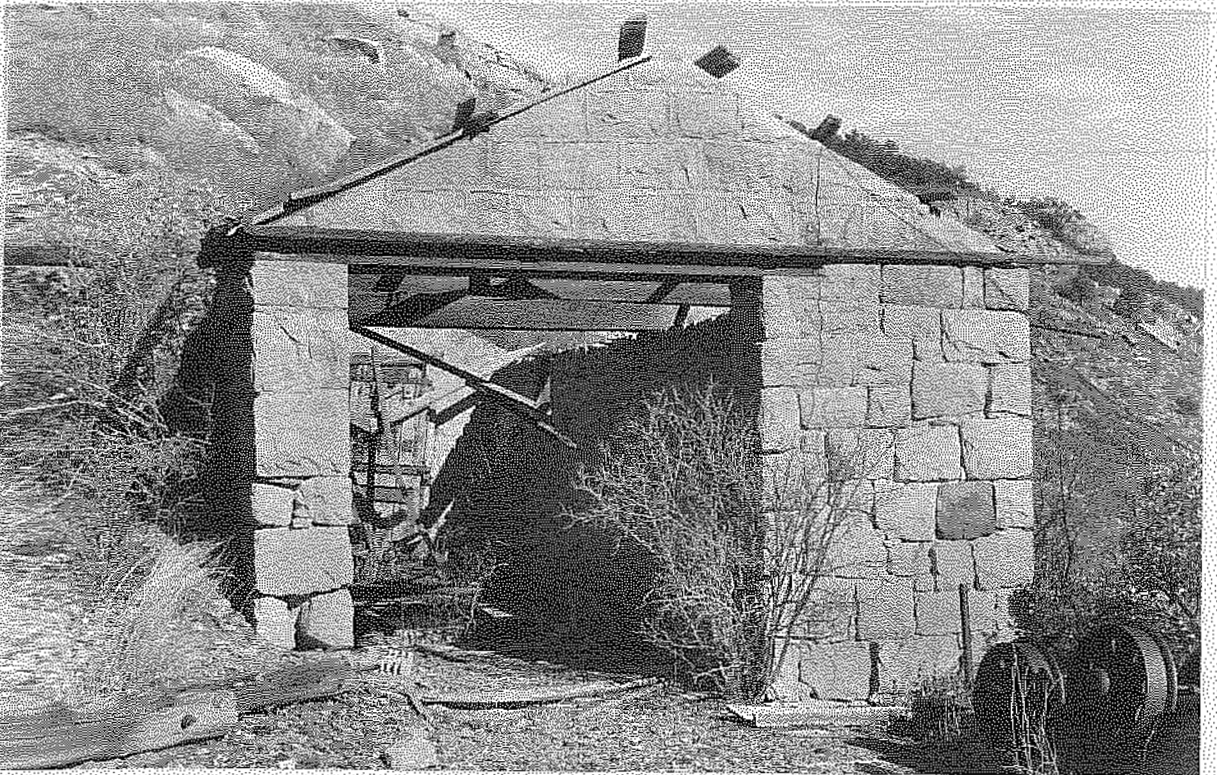


FIG. 13. Old Koehler Mine No. 1 winding house.
Tram line extended up hill to fan house.

was constructed after this date. Wire nails are used in the exposed boards. Two single pane windows (82 by 76 cm) are located on each side of the building with one longer one on the rear wall. Set into the center of the floor is a concrete box of 2.8 by 0.9 m which once held the winding mechanism that hauled the wooden coal cars down the hill from the adit. Roof beams, metal machinery parts, and a wooden coal cart lie on the floor of the winding house. Purple glass, metal fragments, and a wooden coal cart are sparsely scattered around the outside of the structure.

Wood ties of a former railroad bed extend for 9.0 m from the winding house to the edge of the knoll where coal was then loaded onto mechanical transports out of the canyon. Another track bed leads north away from the knoll edge, across a 4.0 m long rock bridge around a low hill, and up a short side canyon to other adits associated with the Old Koehler No. 1 Mine.

In the side canyon, Adit #1 has been dug directly into the sandstone bedrock. The opening is 4.0 by 2.0 m and is not framed. Adit #2 is also dug into the sandstone bedrock and has larger 16.5 inch timbers which have collapsed the entrance. The ends of the timbers have been axe-cut. Adit #3 is an unframed opening dug into the bedrock and measures 1.75 by .50 m. Adit #4 has large collapsed timbers which have been notched to support another large cross-beam. Opening of the adit is 4 by 2.25 m.

Twelve meters northwest of Adit #4 in the center of the narrow canyon are the partial remains of a sandstone structure measuring 3.8 by 2.0 m with a standing corner of 2.05 m. It is set on the edge of a flat sandstone boulder. A short wooden plank bridge runs from the boulder across the small creek to the other side of the canyon. No artifacts were associated with the structural remains. The size of the structure suggests it was not a residence but a small, mine-related building.

Adit #5 is at the head of the canyon and is not related to the Old Koehler No. 1 Mine. It consists of the collapsed frame of large timber posts which have been notched. The opening of the adit measures 3.0 by 1.5 m. None of the adits has associated cultural material except for #4.

There is a rock-walled powder house across the canyon from the adit. It measures 2.9 by 2.0 m.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to install a concrete closure across the adit opening within the fan house at the Old Koehler No.1 Mine. The fan house will not be altered in any way. Access to the structure will be by foot from the canyon. The winding house will likewise not be affected. The bureau plans to dynamite Adits #1 through 5 so that the openings are collapsed and sealed. Transport of dynamite will be by foot and will not disturb the structure near Adit #4. The powder house will also not be affected by closing activities.

IX-Koehler Gob Pile and Adits (LA 57196)

Location: UTM [REDACTED]

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: A large gob pile (coal waste) located on the floor of Praire Crow Canyon is burning internally. It measures 1.2 by 0.2 km and is 15.0 to 20.0 m high. There is a small drainage along the north edge of the gob pile. No structures are located on or immediately adjacent to the pile (Figs. 14 and 15).

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to divert the drainage away from the gob pile and to heavily mulch and seed the area. The bureau will also construct a small drainage channel along the south edge of the gob pile.

In a side canyon directly south of the gob pile are three adits located on an encircling bench. Adit A is a drift (a sloping adit) measuring 2.75 by 2.0 m. It is dug directly into the sandstone with no framework. Ten meters north of the adit is a rock foundation with partially standing walls of rock with concrete mortar. It measures 6.7 by 4.9 m with the back wall dug into the hill. There is an enclosed rock-walled area within the structure. A tin roof has collapsed into the interior so that the floor is not visible. No artifacts were observed in association with the building which is thought to represent a mine-related structure rather than residence.

Thirty meters south of Adit A is another adit (Adit B). The opening measures 2.8 by 1.5 m. It is framed with heavy 18 inch timbers which have been notched to support a timber lintel. It has been roofed and walled with small timbers (Fig. 16). There is a dry-laid rock retaining wall 7.0 m in length extending out from the adit opening.

Twelve meters northeast of Adit B is a small rock and concrete structure measuring 5.8 by 6.0 m and divided into two rooms. A gasoline can, corrugated tin, and some brick are lying near the structure. One brick reads "VITRIFIED BRICK & T. CO. COFFEYVILLE, KS."

Adit C is situated across the steep narrow canyon from adits A and B. Dry-laid sandstone frames the 1.7 by 1.2 m opening which has been dug into the hill. The lintel is an old railroad tie.

Portions of an old railroad bed can be seen along the bench on which the adits are located. Discarded wooden coal carts lie on the slopes of the steep canyons.

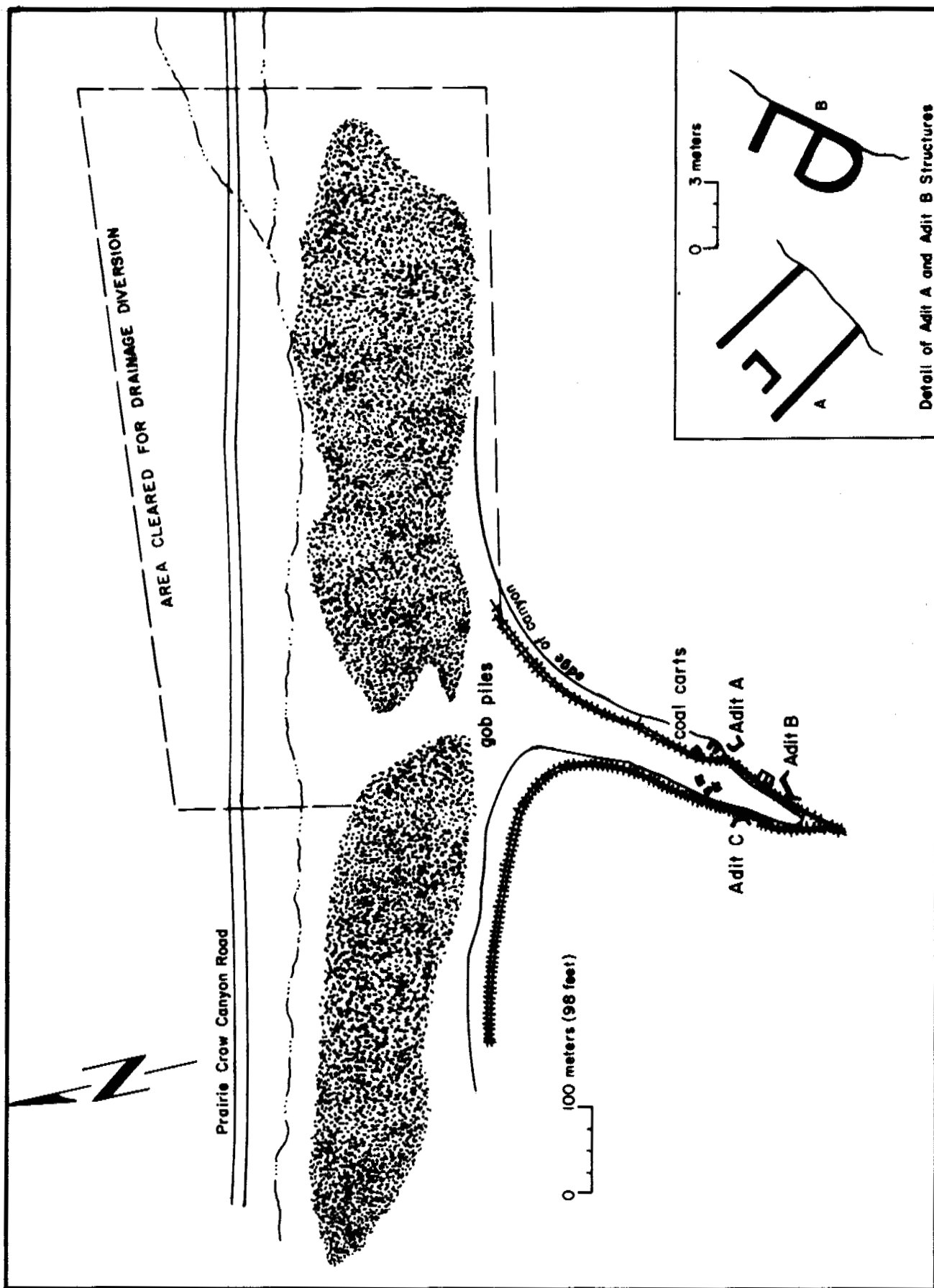


Figure 14. Plan view of Koehler gob pile and adits.



FIG. 15. Koehler gob pile, currently on fire.



FIG. 16. Adit B at Koehler, with timbered and notched opening.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to dynamite shut the openings to adits B and C, and backfill Adit A by hand. The structures located near the adits will not be affected. Access to the area will be by foot. The bureau may also elect to recoup the abandoned coal carts and present them to Kaiser Steel Corporation for possible museum use.

X-Talbot Mine (LA 57197)

Location: UTM Zone [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, 1923 to 1964.

Ownership: Private, Mr. Reno Guerra.

Description: The Talbot Mine consists of an adit, air shaft, a collapsed tibble, several residences, and a privy (Fig. 17). The adit is set within a small ravine at the base of a low rise (Fig. 18). It measures 1.4 by 1.1 m and has a timbered opening constructed from square beams which have been notched to receive the lintel. The adit has a log roof made from small poles. A locked metal gate extends across the adit opening. A dry-laid rock retaining wall extends 3.0 m out from the adit.

A partially dismantled and collapsing tibble sits on the west edge of the site (Fig. 19). Four square timber supports and some cross-beams are all that remain and are in danger of further collapse. Wire nails are present on the boards. A coal pile sits directly north of the tibble.

Three structures are located south of the dirt access road and are part of the mine operations. One is the residence of the former mine owner (Fig. 20). The building has completely collapsed. It had a board siding and a tin roof, presumably pitched. The foundation measures 8.0 by 5.0 m. Wire nails protrude from the loose boards lying on the ground. Immediately east of the residence is a still-standing privy measuring 1.5 square meters, with board siding and a pitched roof.

The remaining structure on the site is a former miner's shack. It is in complete disrepair and partially collapsed (Fig. 21). It is constructed of vertical boards covered with asphalt siding in a yellow brick design, and has a pitched roof of wood. Remains of a red brick chimney lay on the ground nearby along with an old refrigerator, metal wash tub, and a Model T dump truck with a wood frame. The building foundation measures 7.0 by 4.0 m. According to the present owner of the land, the miner's shack was moved to the site ca. 1940 from the former mining community of Brilliant.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to backfill or seal the entry to the adit. The air shaft will also be backfilled. With the landowner's permission, they propose to remove the remaining portions

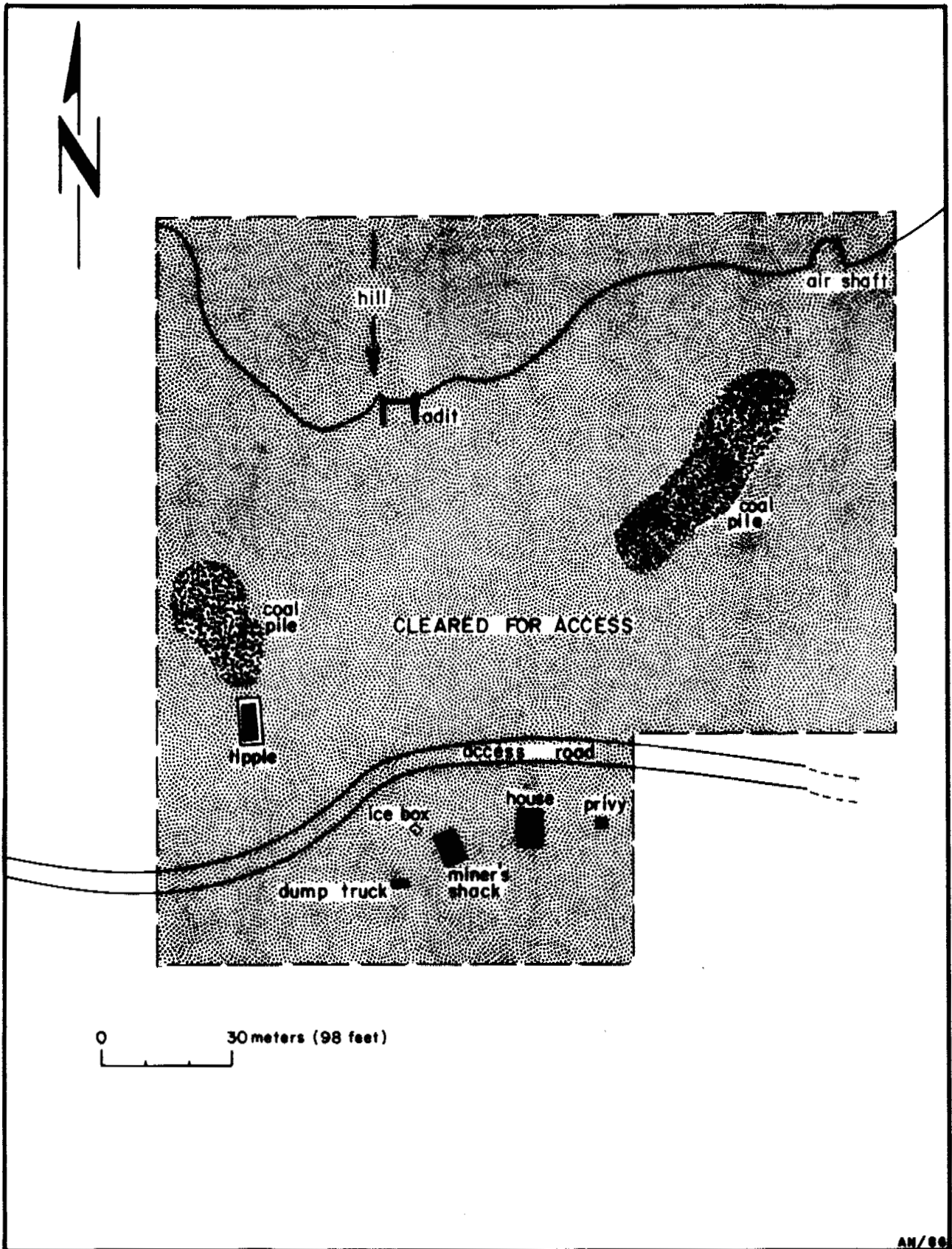


Figure 17. Plan view of Talbot Mine.

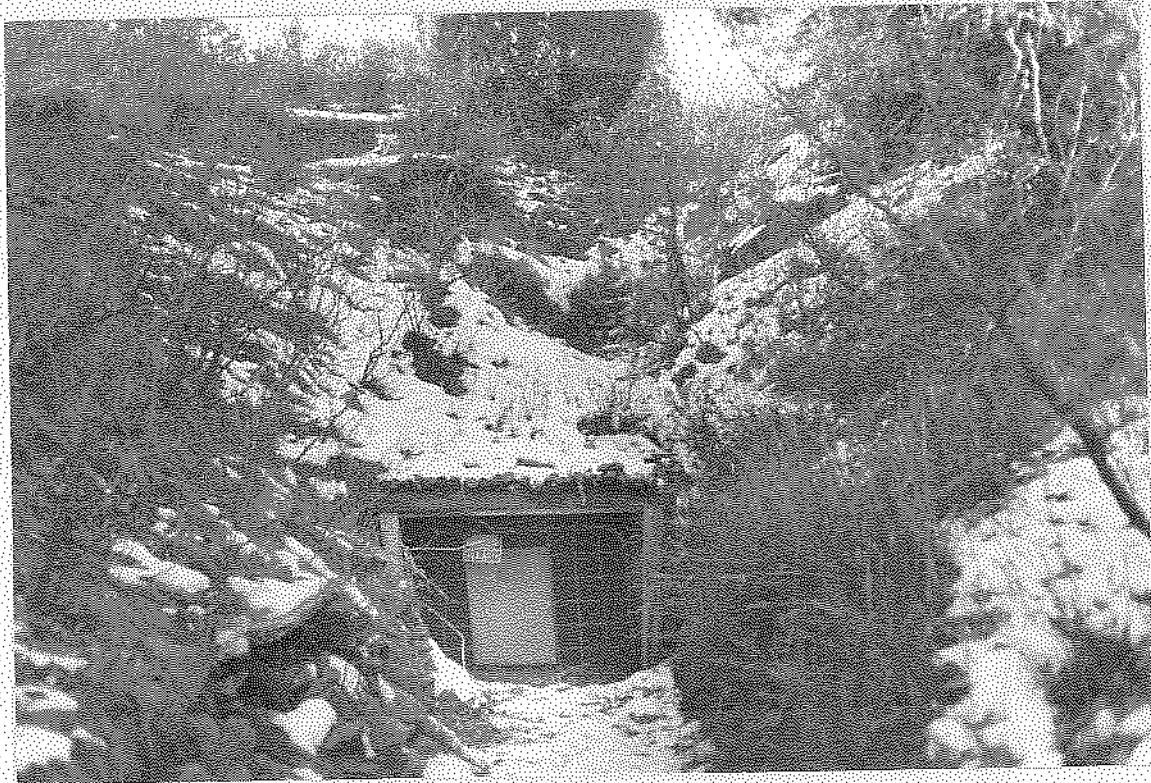


FIG. 18. Adit at Talbot Mine.



FIG. 19. Remains of tippie, Talbot Mine.

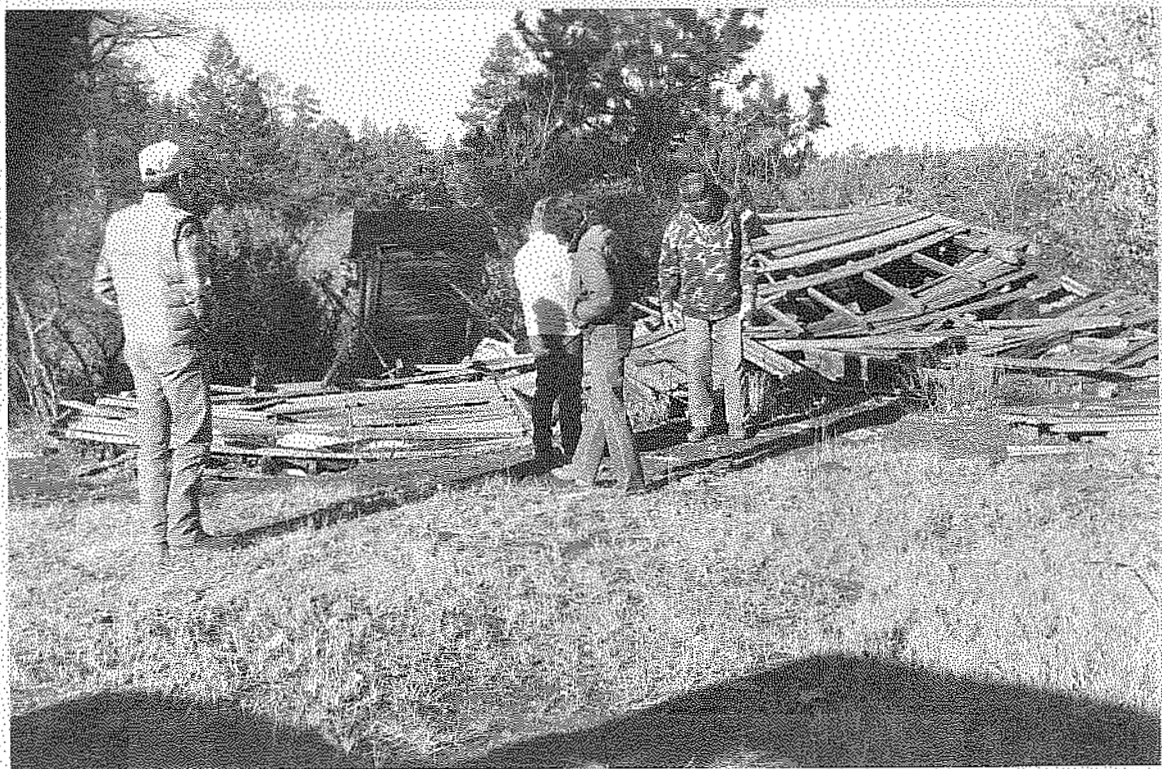


FIG. 20. Mine owner's residence, Talbot Mine.

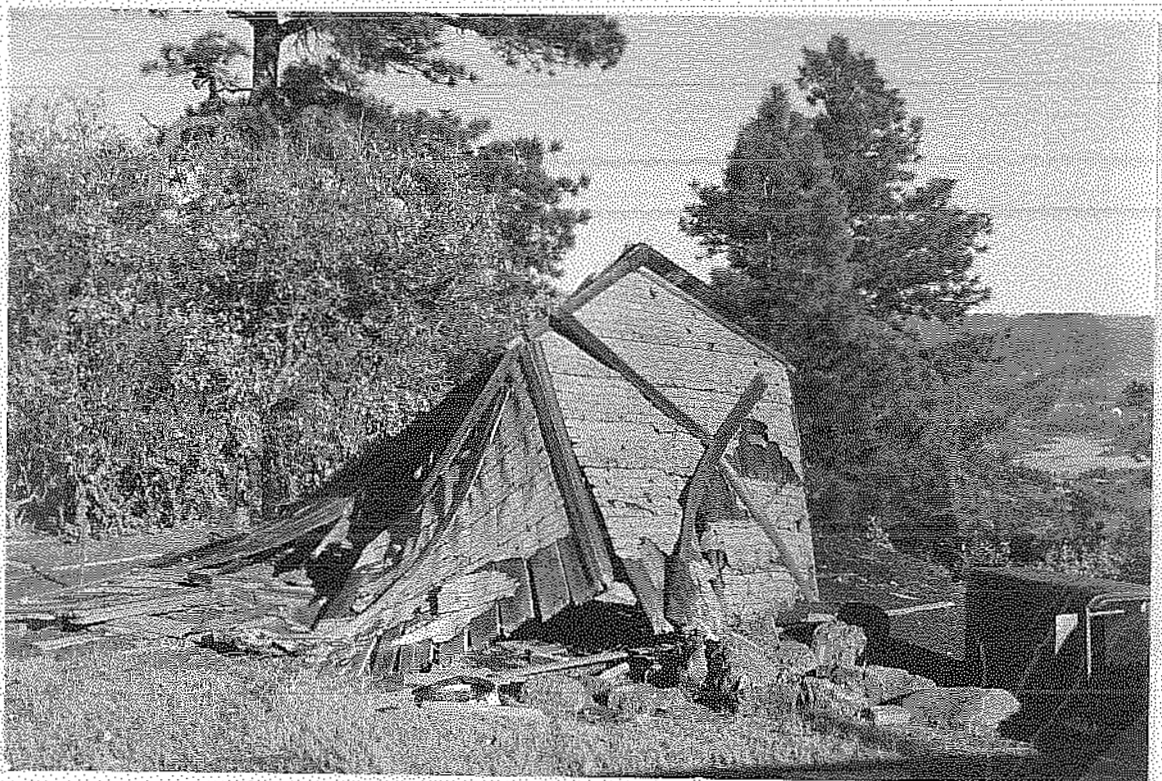


FIG. 21. Miners' shack, Talbot Mine.

of the tibble, mine owner's residence, and miners shack. The loose boards from the structures contain numerous protruding nails which, according to the landowner have injured cattle and wildlife. The privy will be left standing. Research Section archaeologists have archaeologically cleared the surrounding lands and access road for the entry of heavy equipment on the site.

XI-Waldron Canyon (LA 57198)

Location: UTM Zone [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, unknown to 1962.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: The mine features at the site are located in a remote canyon which is seasonally accessible (Fig. 22). Approach to the site may be made by vehicle to within 0.2 km; thereafter, foot traffic or horseback is necessary. The site consists of two adits, a fan house, and a railroad trestle.

Adit #1 is a poured concrete structure with an attached air course into the adit (Fig. 23). The opening is 3.5 by 3.0 m with wire and metal pipe across it. Dates on an interior beam range from 8-26-55 to 9-19-62. No artifacts were in association with the structure. There is a fan house of poured concrete 16.0 m to the north of Adit #1. The entry has been sealed previously.

Adit #2 is situated 20.0 m east of Adit #1 across a narrow arroyo. It is constructed of cinder block with an opening of 3.0 by 2.0 m (Fig. 24). A cinder block retaining wall juts out 3.2 m from the entry. The interior roof of the adit has collapsed.

Approximately 0.3 km south of the adits are the remains of a railroad trestle which crosses the arroyo (Fig. 25 and 26). The bed is constructed of board planking placed over steel girders.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to install a masonry closure across the entrance to Adit #1. It will backfill Adit #2 by hand. The nearby fan house and railroad trestle will not be affected by closure activities. Research Section personnel have archaeologically cleared the 0.3 km access route into the site.

XII-Dutchman Mine (LA 57199)

Location: UTM Zone 13, XXXXX, XXXXX N.

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, ca. 1880 to 1894.

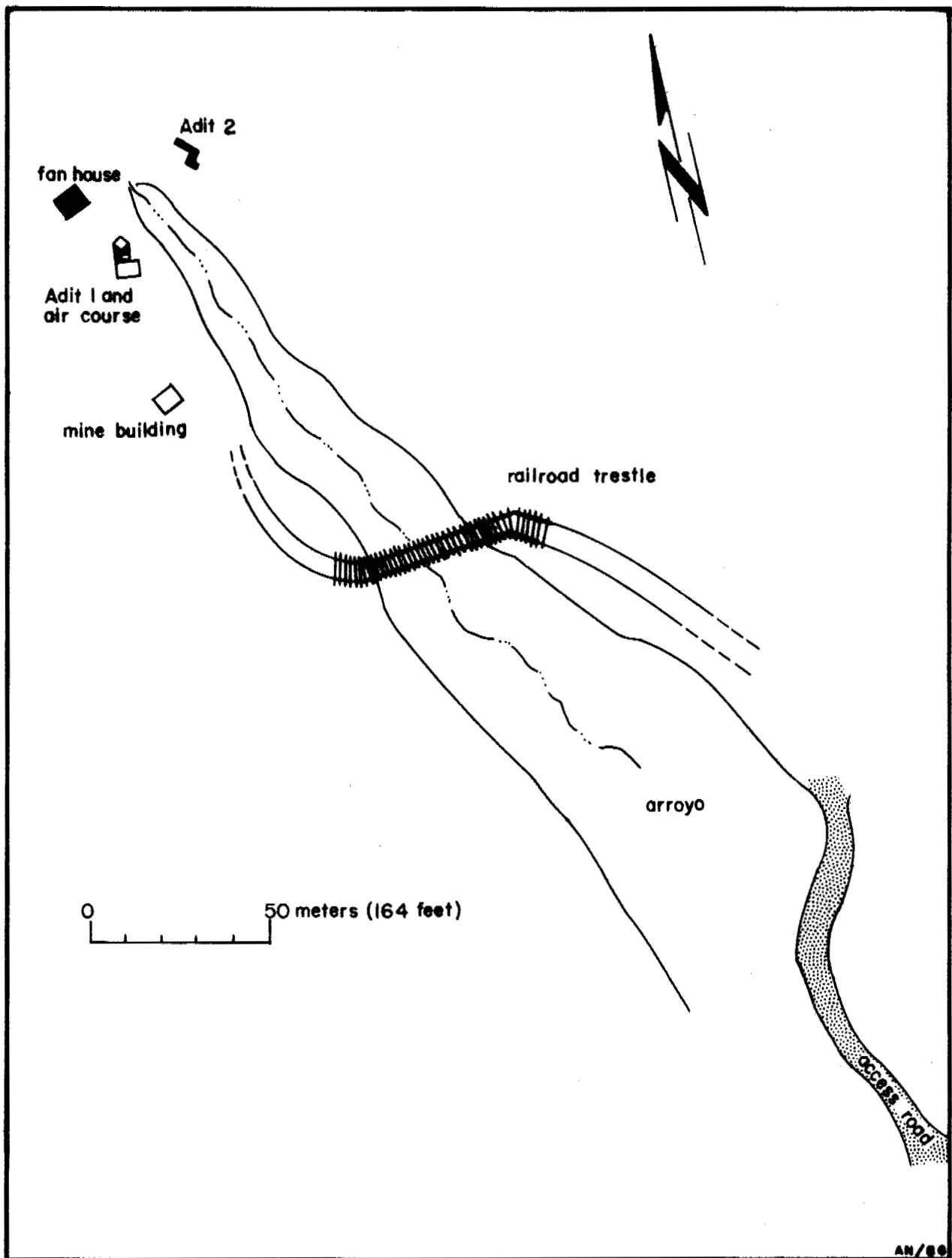


Figure 22. Plan view of Waldron Canyon Mines.

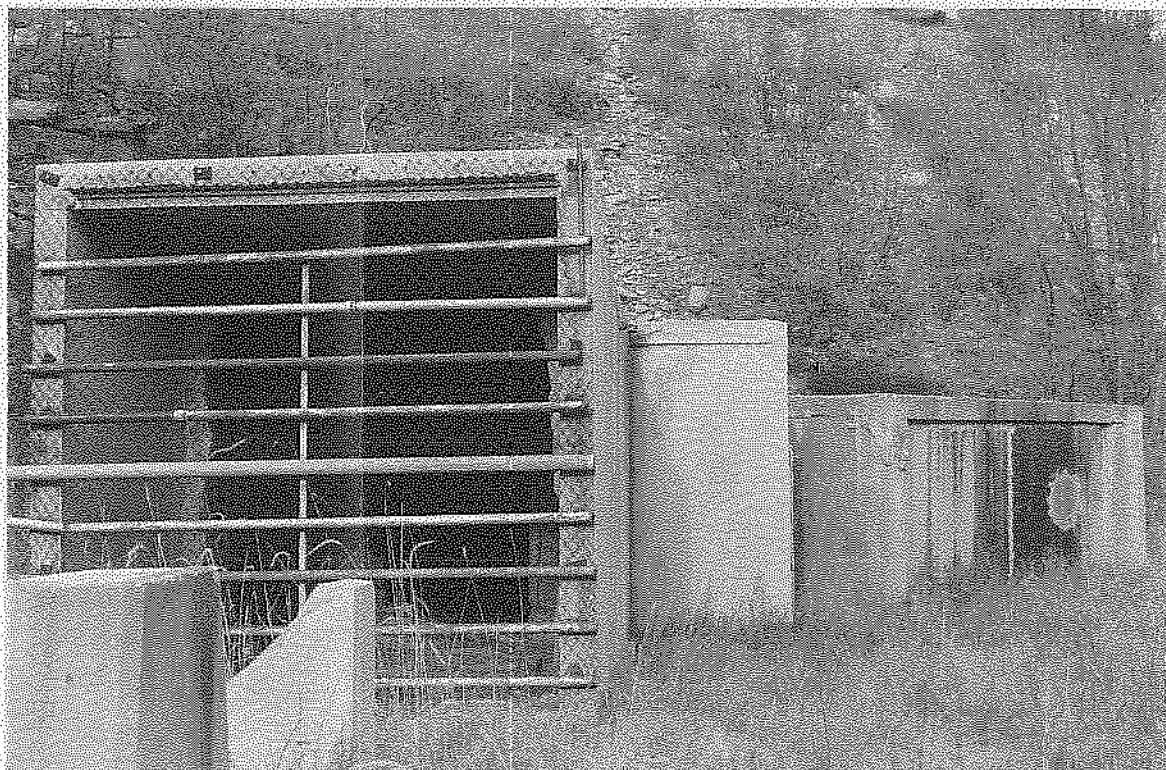


FIG. 23. Adit No. 1 and air course, Waldron Canyon.



FIG. 24. Adit No. 2, Waldron Canyon.

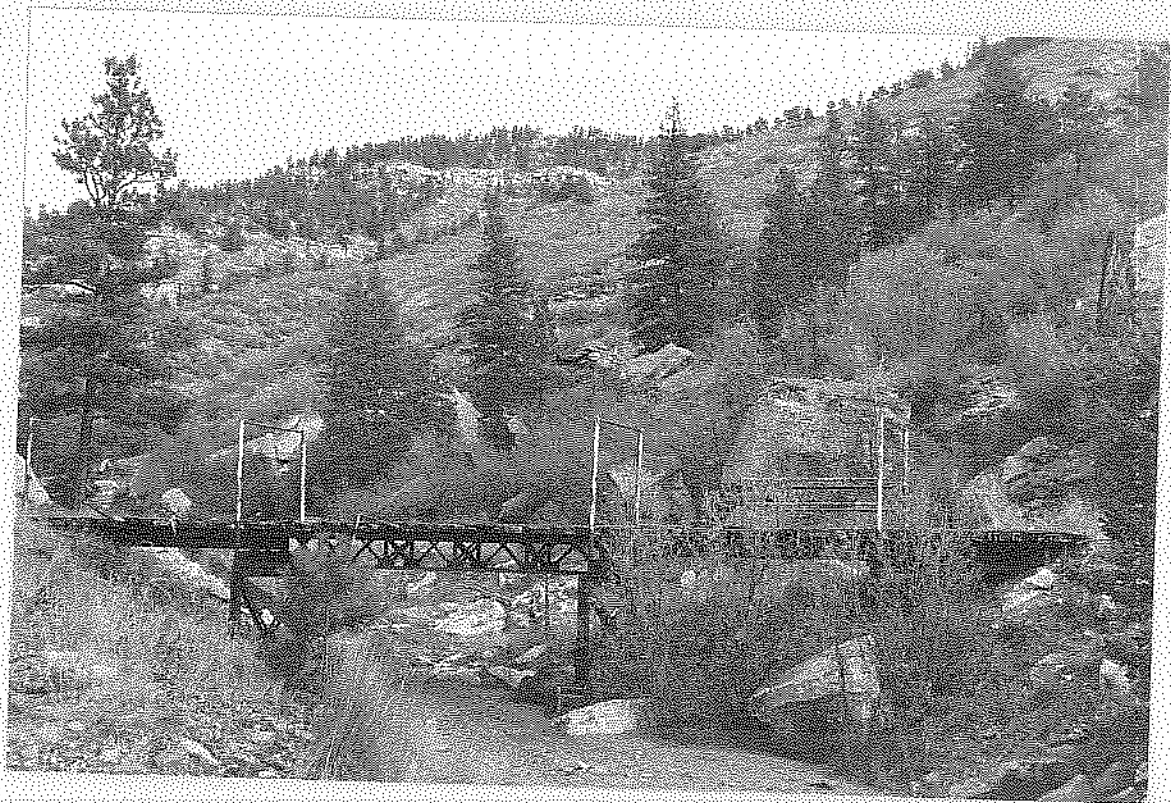


FIG. 25. Railroad trestle, Waldron Canyon.

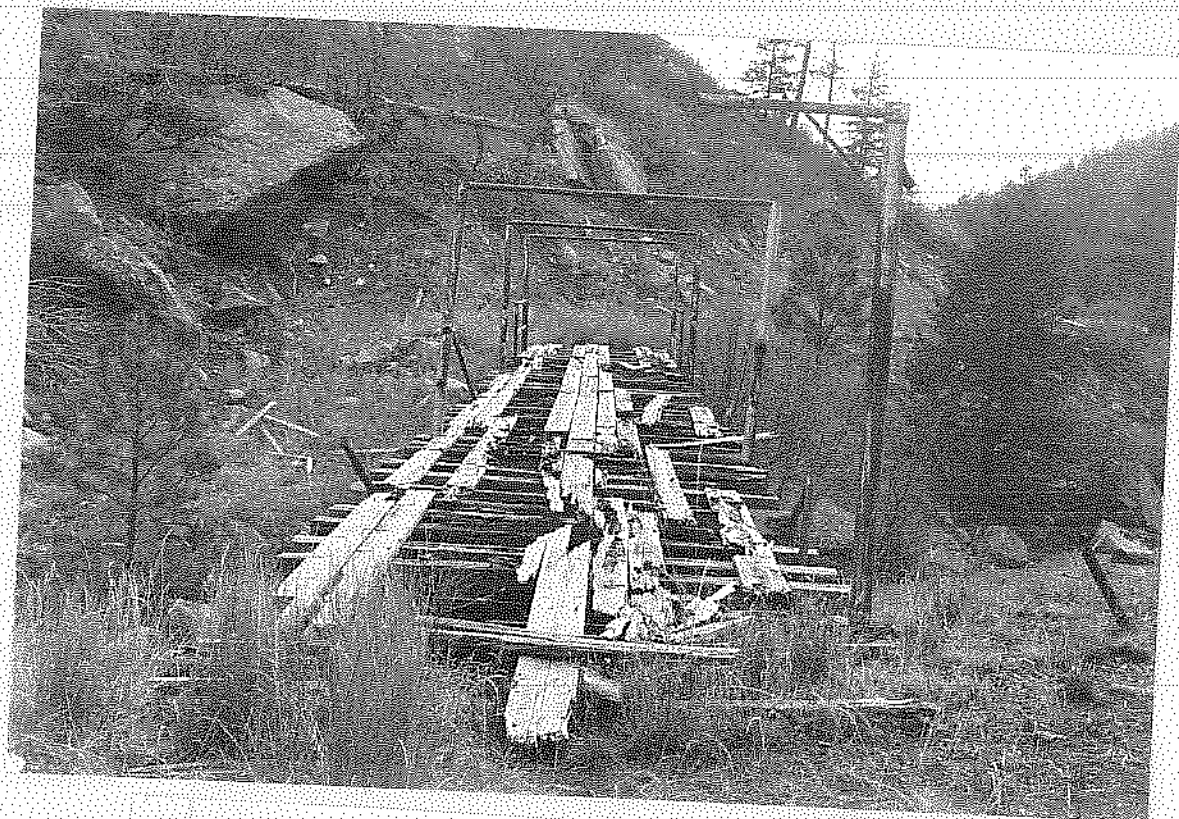


FIG. 26. Close-up of railroad trestle, Waldron Canyon.

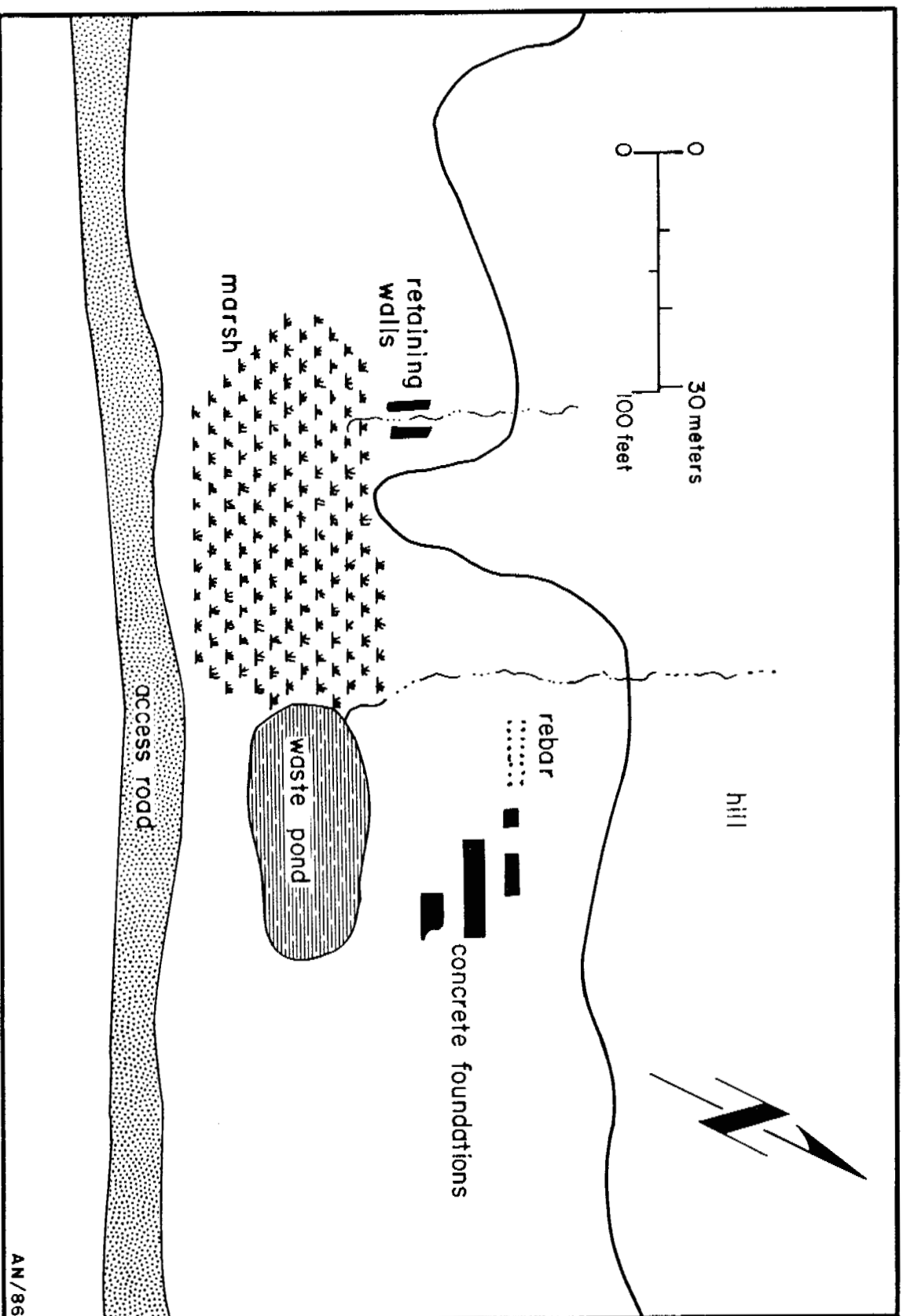


Figure 27. Waste pond and structures, Dutchman Mine.

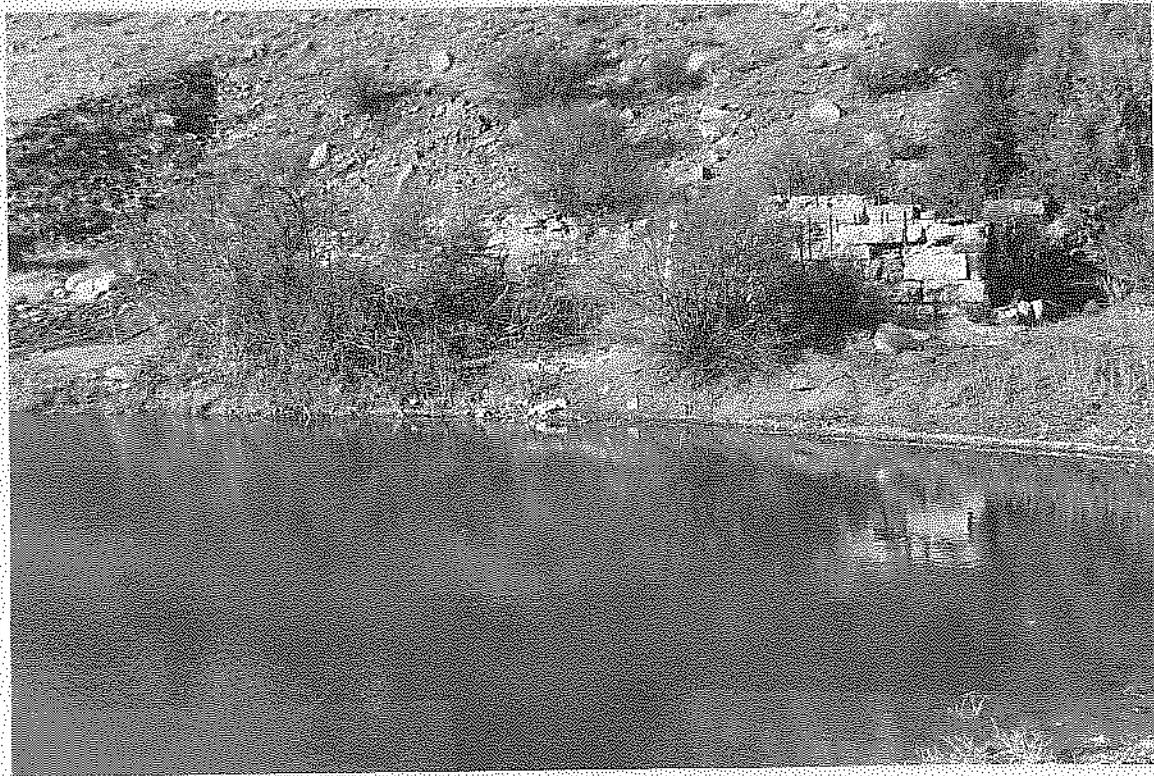


FIG. 28. Waste pond and structure at Dutchman Mine.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: The site consists of the remains of a tram loading dock, several retaining walls, and a waste pond (Fig. 27). The sandstone and mortar foundations to the tram loading dock are reinforced with rebar and located at the base of a moderately steep hill and adjacent to a waste pond (Fig. 28). Measurements of the structure are 18.0 by 10.0 m. The soil around the structure is marshy and continually wet. No artifacts were found near the structures. The waste pond measures 25.0 by 12.0 m and is acidic.

Thirty-five meters west are two short sandstone and mortar retaining walls 2.0 m apart. Another acidic area of standing water extends from the hill and passes between these walls creating another marshy environment.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to reclaim the waste pond and drainages and make them a safe habitat for wildlife. At present there is heavy metal contamination of the waters. These will be drained and neutralized and cattails planted. The structural remains will not be affected.

XIII-North Yankee Mine and the Franks Mine (LA 57200)

Location: UTM Zone 13:



Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, ca. 1940s.

Ownership: Private.

Description: The North Yankee Mine consists of a single collapsed adit within a small depression located in a heavily forested area on a steep mountain slope. Small poles from the collapsed roof are visible. The opening is less than 30.0 cm high.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to dynamite the opening to further collapse and seal it off. Access to the site is by jeep trail and then overland by foot to the adit. These accesses have been archaeologically cleared by Research Section personnel.

The Franks Mine located on a bench in a heavily wooded mountainous area. The site (LA 57200) consists of an adit, three structures, and remains of a tibble and tram (Fig. 29). The adit has been cut into the sandstone bedrock. The entry has collapsed and there are large sandstone boulders across it.

Five meters east of the adit is a cinderblock structure (#1) with partially collapsed walls and roof (Fig. 30), measuring 5.0 by 5.0 m. Another cinderblock structure (#2) measuring 12.0 by 5.0 m is located against the hill fifteen meters southeast of the adit. The wood roof is collapsed. No artifacts were located near these structures. Structure #3 is of frame structure with a pitched roof. The wood floor still remains, but the building is leaning badly. It measures 8.0 by 5.0 m. Some residential trash is lightly scattered around the structure.

The supports for a tibble sit 20.0 m in front of structure #2 (Fig. 31). It consists of squared timbers measuring 10 by 8 inches. The base is 3.4 by 2.1 m and is 2.1 m high. Remains of the support posts of a tram extend for 1.4 km downslope to the valley bottom.

The Abandoned Mine Bureau proposes to dynamite the adit at the Franks Mine to close the opening. No structures will be affected by the closure. Access is by foot up the mountain to an abandoned dirt road leading into the site. Research Section personnel have archaeologically cleared the mountain slope leading to the site.

XIV Van Houten Mines (LA 57202)

Location: UTM Zone 13:

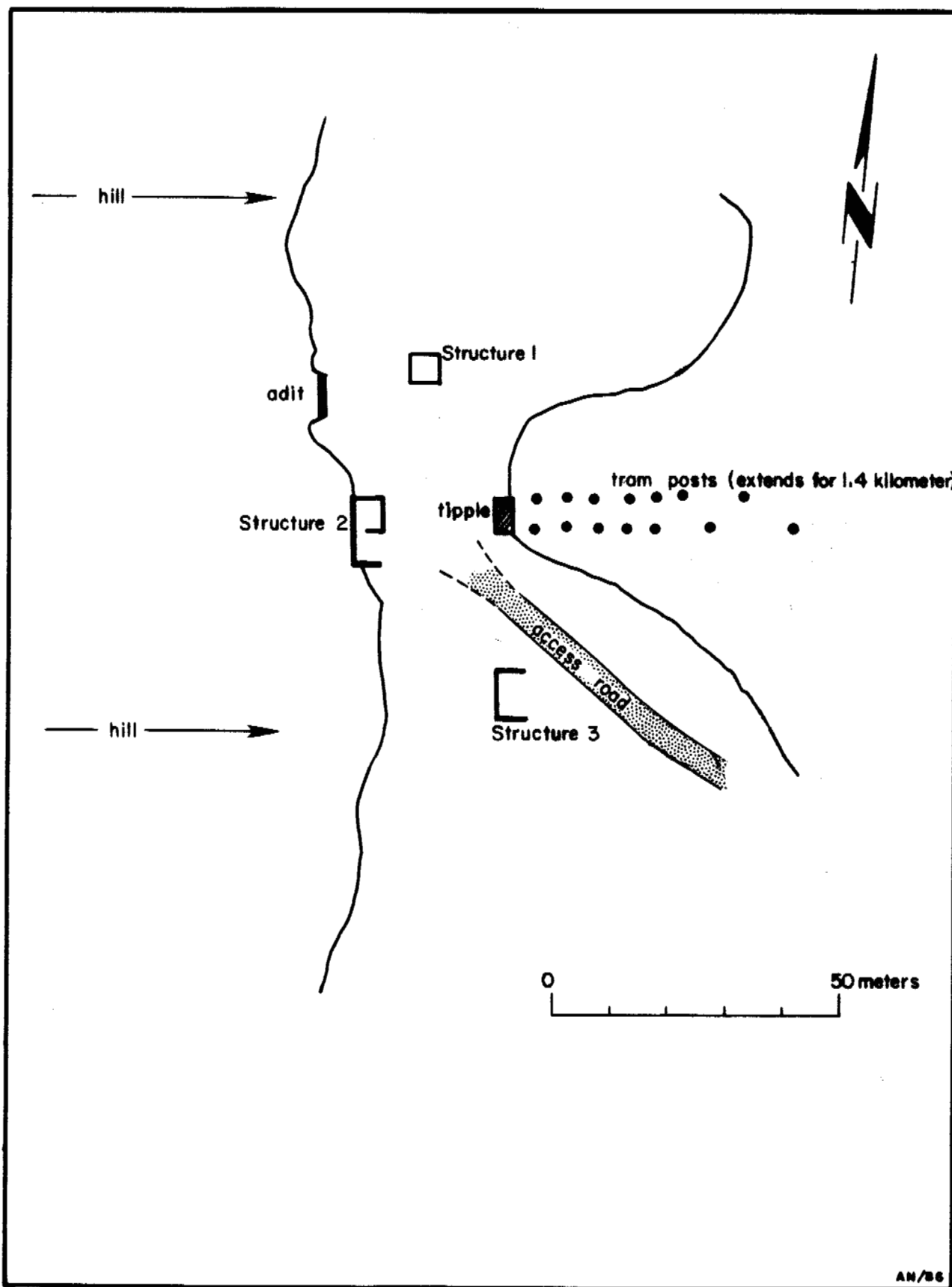


Figure 29. Plan view of Franks Mine.

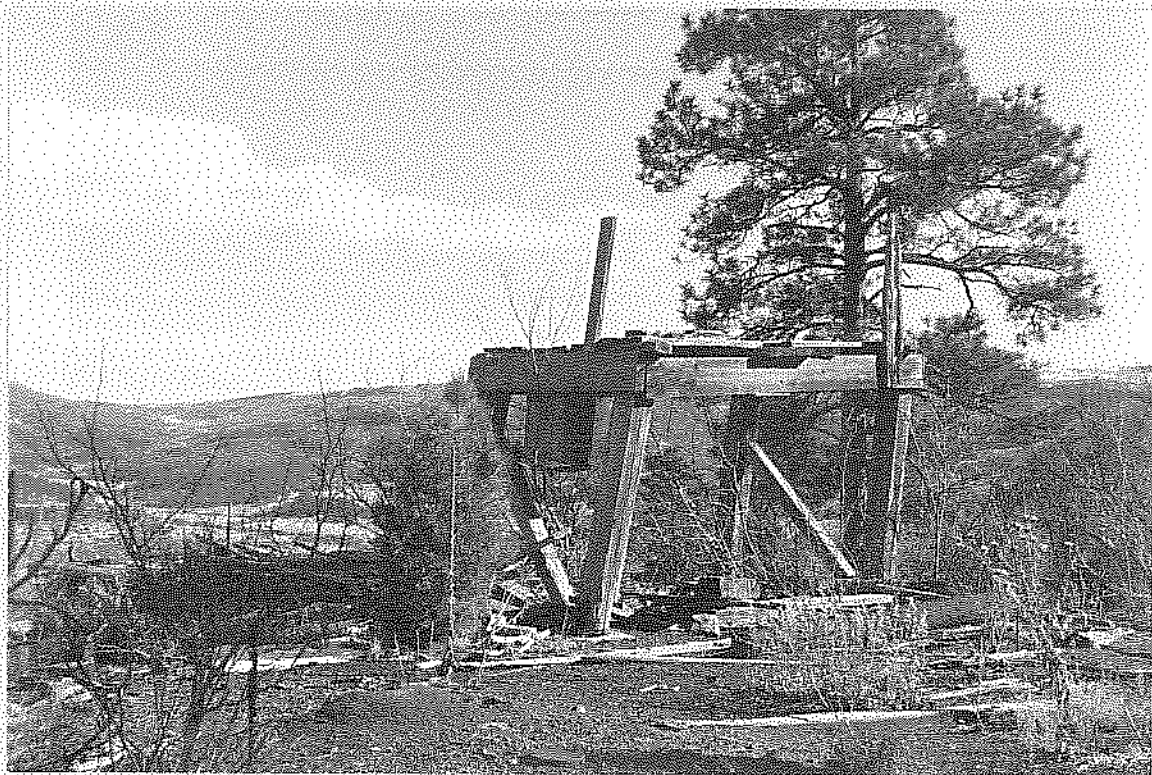


FIG. 31. Tibble base at Franks Mine.



FIG. 30. Cinderblock Structure No. 1 at Franks Mine.



[REDACTED], 1902-1954.

Ownership: Private, National Rifle Association.

Description: The mines at Van Houten are part of the mining community established in approximately 1902. Only a portion of the mines on the site have been archaeologically surveyed (Fig. 32). A total of 14 adits, 2 gob piles, a load-out, screening plant, electric terminal, worker's housing, mine buildings, powder house, a cistern, and a small mining/residential complex were recorded. Access to the mine area is north off U.S. 64 on restricted lands of the National Rifle Association. Most of the mines are located near the mouth of Van Houten Canyon within a pinyon, juniper, and ponderosa pine environment. The mine area is defined by six UTM reference points (Fig. 32).

RR 1: Cistern

A square cistern of rock and mortar lies in an open field near the mouth of Van Houten Canyon (Fig. 33). It measures 5.25 by 5.25 m and 4.0 m deep. It may extend deeper but debris has blocked visibility. A pipe extends into the cistern from the east. The cistern lies 20 m north of the access road. Nickelson (n.d.) reports that the cistern supplied the community with water.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to backfill the cistern from local stockpiles which they will dredge. The cistern has no standing walls and poses a hazard to wildlife and National Rifle Association members. The open field and a 35.0 by 35.0 m area around the cistern have been cleared for access by the archaeologists.

RR 2: Adit

The adit is 30 m west of RR 34 gob pile. It sits against the hillslope, facing northeast (Fig. 34). It is a masonry adit with a rounded arch opening 4.0 m wide and 5.75 m high. The adit was in use from ca. 1902 up to 1954. Interior of the opening is vaulted stone. A heavy locked iron gate closes the entry, and mortar retaining walls extend 3 m out from the opening. "Adit 02" is seen in metal figures above the entry. A dirt road leads to the adit opening.

Fifteen meters east of the adit is a small cinderblock structure 4.6 by 4.6 m with a shed roof. It has two side window frames and a wood-frame entry. It sits 5.0 m south of the road. The abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to install a masonry seal, instead of the metal gate, across the opening to the adit to prevent entry by passersby and wildlife.

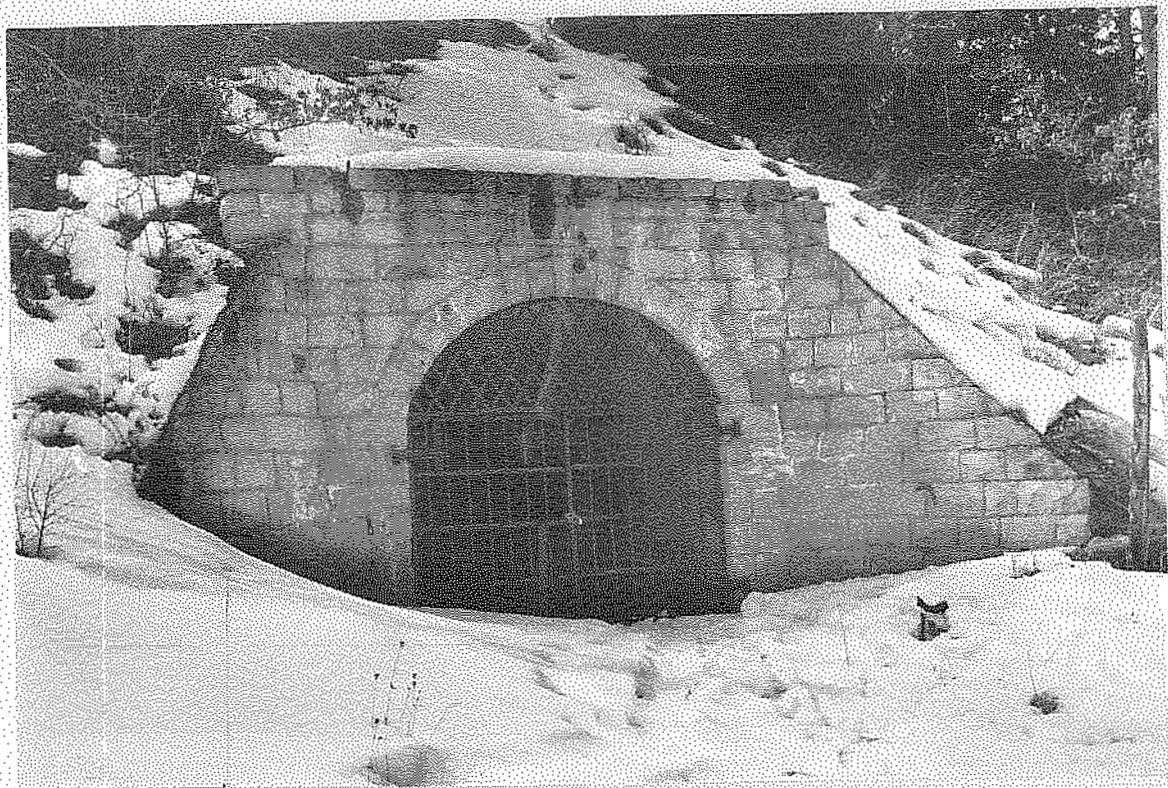


FIG. 33. Van Houten cistern, facing north.



FIG. 34. Adit RR 2, Van Houten.

RR 3 and 4: Adit

Two adits are located 250.0 m up Spring Canyon from its junction with Van Houten Canyon. They lie on either side of the canyon 35.0 m up the steep canyon walls. A gob pile is directly downslope from RR 4. RR 3 was known as Mine No. 1 and RR 4 was Mine No. 2. RR 3 measures 2.0 by 2.0 m, and RR 4 is 2.0 by 3.0 m. No structures or artifacts surround the adits which are dug directly into the canyon sides. Nickelson (n.d.) says the adits were closed in 1924. The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to blast the adits shut. It will also plant cattails at the junction of the canyons to stop continuing creek contamination from coal wastes of the gob pile.

RR 5: Adit

The adit is situated just north of the RR 34 gob pile 30.0 m up the steep canyon wall at the base of a sandstone outcrop. It is dug into the native rock with no external or internal supports. The adit measures 3.4 by 5.1 m. No cultural features or artifacts are near the opening. The abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to hand blast the opening shut.

RR 7 and 25: Adits and Subsidence Area

On a flat ridge projecting into Negro Canyon is a 69,000 area which contains a 20 acre subsidence area and a 30 acre burned area. The subsidence contains 30 man-made pits up to 30.0 m deep, which are continuing to subside. Immediately northeast of the subsidence area is a 30 acre burn resulting from coal waste which occasionally catches fire. Adits RR 7 and RR 25 lie immediately to the west and east upslope from the burn area. Both are dug directly into the sandstone outcrops with no structural features. RR 7 measures 3.0 by 6.0 m and RR 25 is 1.5 by 1.8 m. No cultural features or artifacts are near the adits, subsidence, or burn areas.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to install a 3 strand barbed wire fence around the subsidence and burn area in order to restrict access. They will also blast the adits shut carrying in the necessary equipment by foot.

RR 8: Adits

Two adits, 3 m apart, sit 50 m up a steep hillslope on the north side of Van Houten Canyon. Both measure 1.0 by 1.25 m. A small gob pile lies directly downslope. The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to carry dynamite into the adits by foot and seal them. No cultural features or artifacts are near the adits. Nickelson (n.d.) reports that the adits were first opened in 1902 and probably closed in 1924.

RR 9 through 17: Adits

A series of adits lie 30.0 to 50.0 m above the canyon floor on the steep slopes of the mountain side. They extend for 1350.0 m along the hillslope. All are dug directly into the sandstone outcropping with no

associated structural features. RR 9 measures 1.0 by 1.5 m; RR 10 is 1.0 by 1.6 m; RR 11 is 0.90 by 1.1 m; RR 12 is 1.5 by 1.8 m; RR 13 is sealed off; RR 14 is 1.8 by 2.1 m; RR 15 is closed off; RR 16 is 1.8 by 2.1 m; and RR 17 is 2.1 by 1.8 m.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to close off the open adits by blasting them shut. Dynamite will be carried into the adits by foot. No cultural features or artifacts are located near the adits.

RR 30: Gob Pile

A gob pile approximately 75.0 by 100.0 m by 50.0 m in height is situated on the slope of a wooded canyon. The gob pile is currently burning internally. A small creek flows along the base of the waste pile to the northeast. Access to the gob pile is across an open field 45.0 m west of the pile to the existing dirt road that passes through the canyon. No cultural features were associated with the gob pile.

The Abandoned Mine Bureau proposes to either haul the coal away from the gob pile or divert waste from the pile through new drainage channels around the gob pile. Vehicular access across the field to the gob pile has been cleared archaeologically.

RR 33: Mining Complex

A complex of mining structures and residences are situated at a wide spot in Van Houten Canyon (Fig. 35). A wood frame load-out is immediately adjacent to the access road (Fig. 36). It is constructed of 2 by 8 inch timbers that are fastened together with heavy bolts. Several of the timbers are loose. The load-out stands ca. 10.0 m high and extends 12.0 m downslope. It sits on 3 rock and mortar supports. A 4.0 by 3.0 m platform with collapsed side rails remains on top of the load-out and is accessible from the slope against which it stands. The 2.0 by 2.0 m wide chute is lined on its sides with sheets of tin and is floored with corrugated tin. Ten meters east of the load-out is a collapsed privy.

Immediately in front of the load-out to the north and west is a very large rock foundation of a screening plant structure (#1) with portions of red brick walls still standing (Fig. 37). It measures 40.0 by 16.0 m and is divided into two sections. Portions of coursed brick walls stand 9.0 m high and 0.52 cm thick. The west section has an exposed basement 6.0 m deep of dry-laid dressed sandstone. Four window openings on the southeast walls are framed in 2 by 8 inch boards. The interior of this section contains collapsed roof beams, and twisted metal sheets. A 4.0 by 5.0 by 4.5 m high rock and mortar structure with unparallel walls sits within this area. The roof is missing; but a closet of 0.60 by 0.75 cm remains within it.

The east section has an eroding concrete floor mostly covered with brick rubble. Three railroad ties are embedded in the northwest end of the area. A small, 27.0 by 27.0 cm, hole allows a view down to a basement or storage area at 2.0 m below the floor. No access to this floor was seen but it may have been buried beneath the surrounding

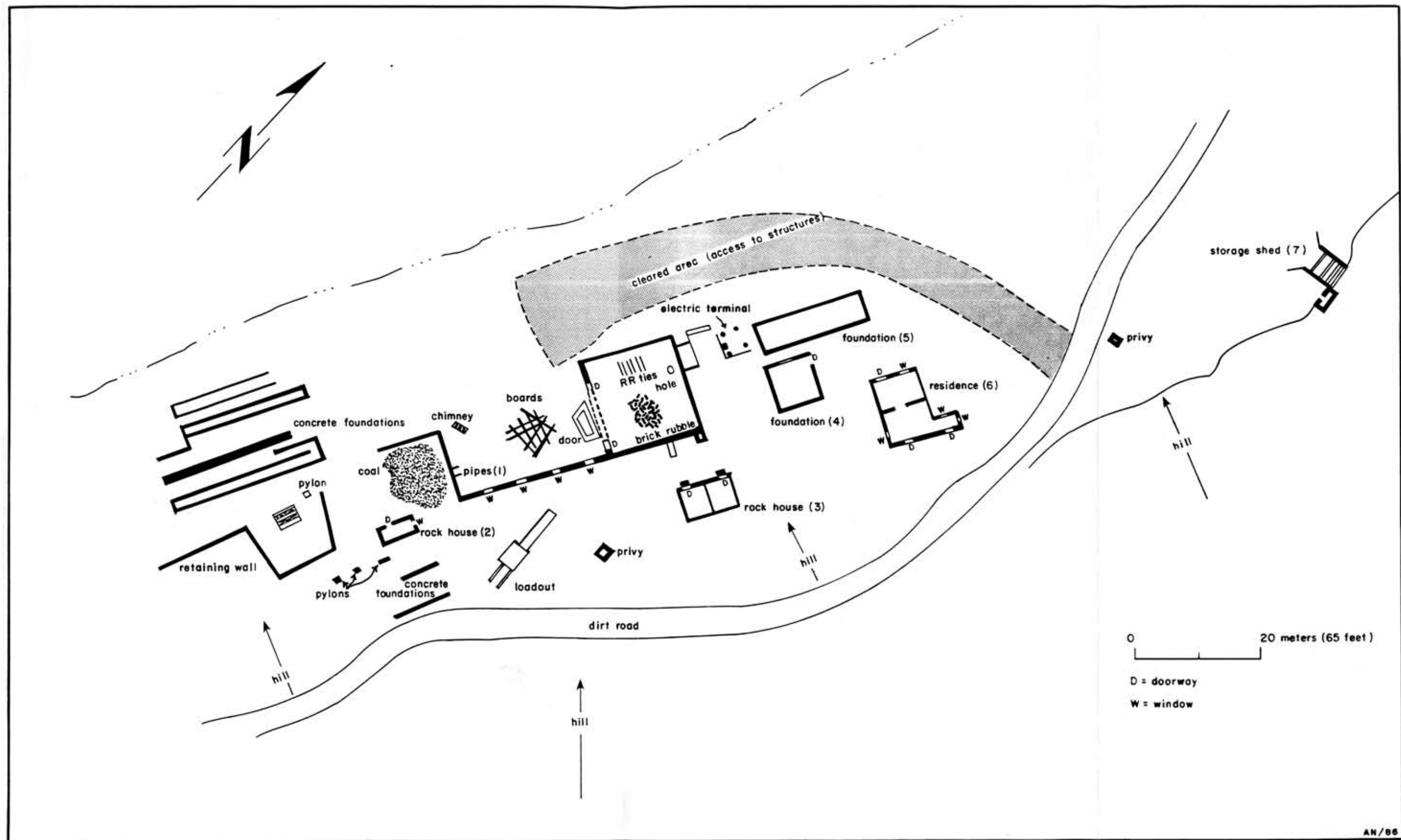


Figure 35. Plan view of RR 13, mining complex.



FIG. 36. Load-out at RR 33.



FIG. 37. Screening plant at RR 33.

rubble. In the west corner of this section, the brick wall extends to 9.0 m in height. Concrete stucco covered with patches of white plaster remain on the interior wall. The wall extends from the corner for 4.0 m on one side and 2.0 m on the other and is quite unstable (Fig. 38).

West of the screening plant is a small 7.0 by 2.2 m rock and mortar structure (#2) with a northwest facing door and a wood lintel set into the rock above the door (Fig. 39). Four-pane windows are set in each end of the interior. Upslope behind the building are several tiers of concrete foundations. There are also several concrete pylons in this area.

Further to the west is a concrete retaining wall of 2.75 m built against the hill slope. The interior space could have served as a covered room. A cement block of 3.0 by 4.0 m sits in the interior with 2 railroad ties bolted to it. A concrete pylon stands to the side. Immediately in front of this wall to the northwest are narrow rows of 25.0 m long concrete foundations with concrete pylons spaced ca 2.0 m apart throughout. No structural walls or roofing remain.

Structure #3 sits off of the southeast corner of the screening plant. It is of rock and mortar and measures 8.5 by 6.0 m and is divided into two rooms, each with its own doorway and curved wood lintel. One has a wood door step; the other is of poured conglomerate. There are shelves on the interior walls.

Structure #4 is an 8.0 by 8.0 m foundation with a portion of standing walls 6.0 m in height. White plaster is visible on the interior of the walls. A shingled roof covered with green asphalt sheets has collapsed into the interior. One double-hung window remains in the northwest end. A wood eave remains on this end of the structure (Fig. 40).

Structure #5 consists of a narrow rock foundation, 18.0 by 4.45 m in size. Next to the west end are the four poles of an electric terminal surrounded by a collapsed wire fence.

Structure #6 sits at the east end of the mining complex. It appears to have served as a two-room residence (Fig. 41). It is L-shaped with the main area measuring 12.0 by 8.0 m. The roof is pitched and is made of wood shingles covered with green asphalt. The side addition has a shed roof. A portion of brick chimney remains on the pitched roof. The building is constructed of wood framing overlaid with gray concrete stucco. The flat ceiling has wood slats. Plaster on the interior walls is cream-colored. Wood plank flooring remains but is fragile.

Thirty meters east of the mining complex sits an isolated privy adjacent to the dirt road. It measures 1.4 by 1.4 m by 2.8 m high. It has a wood shingled pitched roof; sides are of shiplap frame.

Another 20.0 m east of the privy are the remains of a probable storage shed set against the hill. It is of chinked rock and mortar

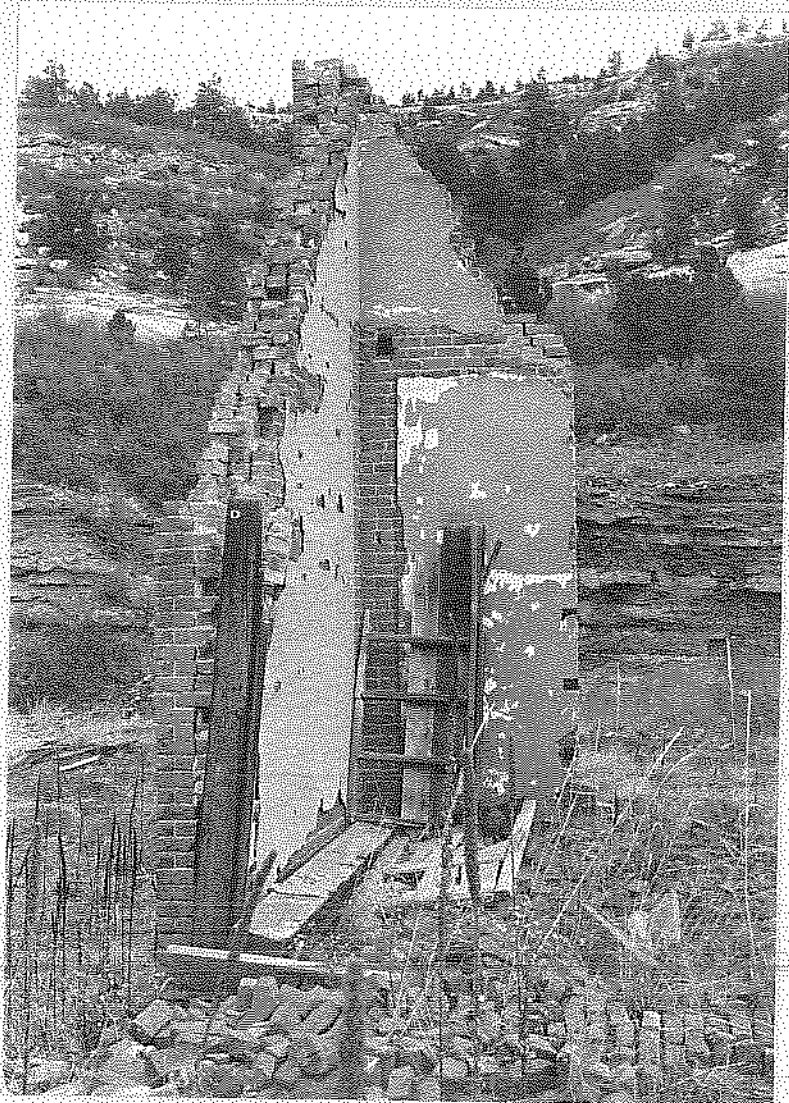


FIG. 38. Standing brick wall of screening plant.



FIG. 39. Structure No. 2 at RR 33.

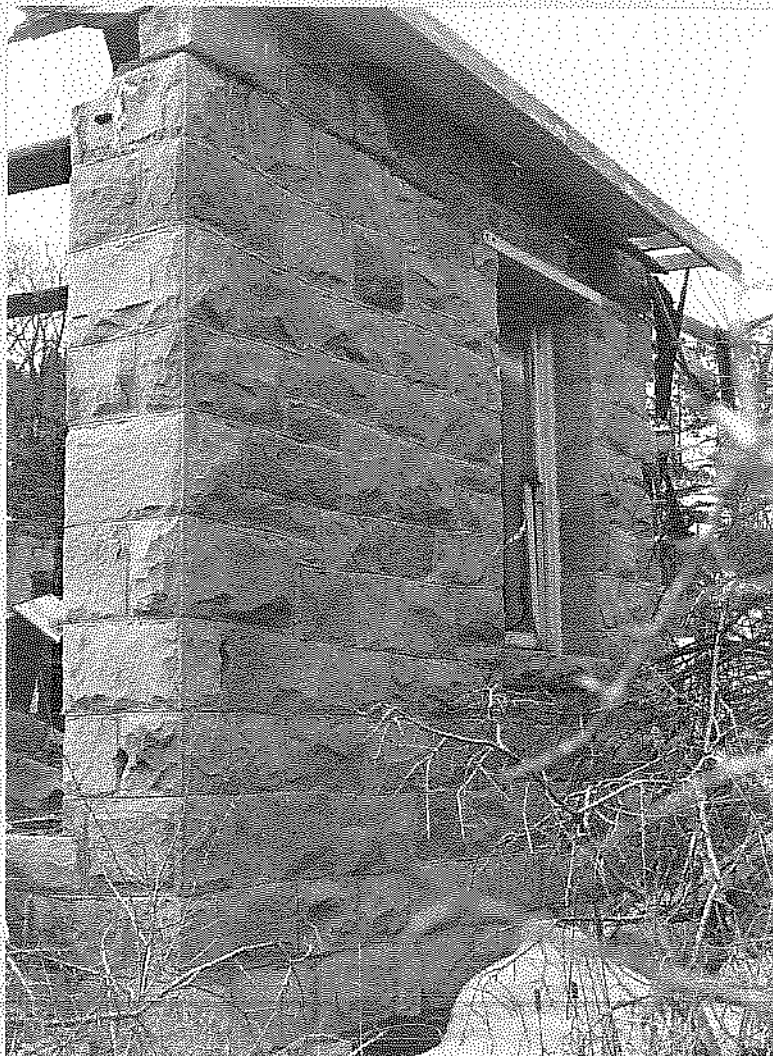


FIG. 40. Structure No. 4
with eave at RR 33.



FIG. 41. Structure No. 6, a residence at
RR 33.

and measures 5.0 by 4.0 m with a small coal shed on the south end. Two large wood doors painted red, stand ajar. The roof is missing, but heavy 6 by 6 inch timbers remain in place. It is likely that a residential structure once occupied this area, but alluviation from the surrounding hill may have erased traces of it.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to dismantle the load-out because of its loose timbers and easy access to the collapsing platform by curious National Rifle Association members. (Last year 10,000 persons had access to the area for recreational purposes). All work will take place adjacent to the existing dirt road.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau also proposes to remove the 9.0 m high standing corner of the brick screening plant (Fig. 38). Collapse of the corner is imminent and presents a hazard to persons walking through the ruins. Access to the corner is by an old dirt route at the east end of the complex and across an open field. This area was cleared by the archaeologist (Fig. 35).

RR 34: Gob Pile

A gob pile covers the south slope of the narrow Van Houten Canyon adjacent to the road. It extends for ca. 200.0 m up the canyon and varies from 20.0 to 30.0 m wide. It is steeply pitched on the east end.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to reduce the steepness of the gob pile by mechanically pushing some of the coal further east in the canyon. This will prevent climbing accidents that could occur because the gob pile is close to the road and a convenient look-out point for the surrounding area.

RR 35: Residential Complex

A small residential area is located directly north of the canyon access road situated at the base of a hill (Fig. 42). A fallen barbed wire fence separates the structures from the road. Many loose boards and metal debris cover the area. There are some fragments of aqua glass around the structures. No trash areas were found. Structures #1 and #4 appear to be coal sheds constructed of wood boards, each measuring 2.2 by 2.0 m and 1.3 m high with shed roofs. West of structure #1 is a rock retaining wall with another rock and brick wall south of it suggesting a structural foundation.

Structure #2 consists of a rock foundation measuring 8.0 by 6.2 m. It is divided into two rooms and was probable a residence. A collapsed board roof with green asphalt covers a portion of the foundation. To the east is a collapsed privy (Structure #4). Remains of a pitched roof covered with tin lie on the ground.

Structure #5 is a rock foundation partially eroded away. No interior features are visible. Another privy (Structure #6) is northeast of the structure. It also has collapsed. Northeast of the privy, against the hill, is a garage-like building (Structure #7) of wood board measuring 5.6 by 3.0 m by 2.5 m high (Fig. 43). A few 2 by

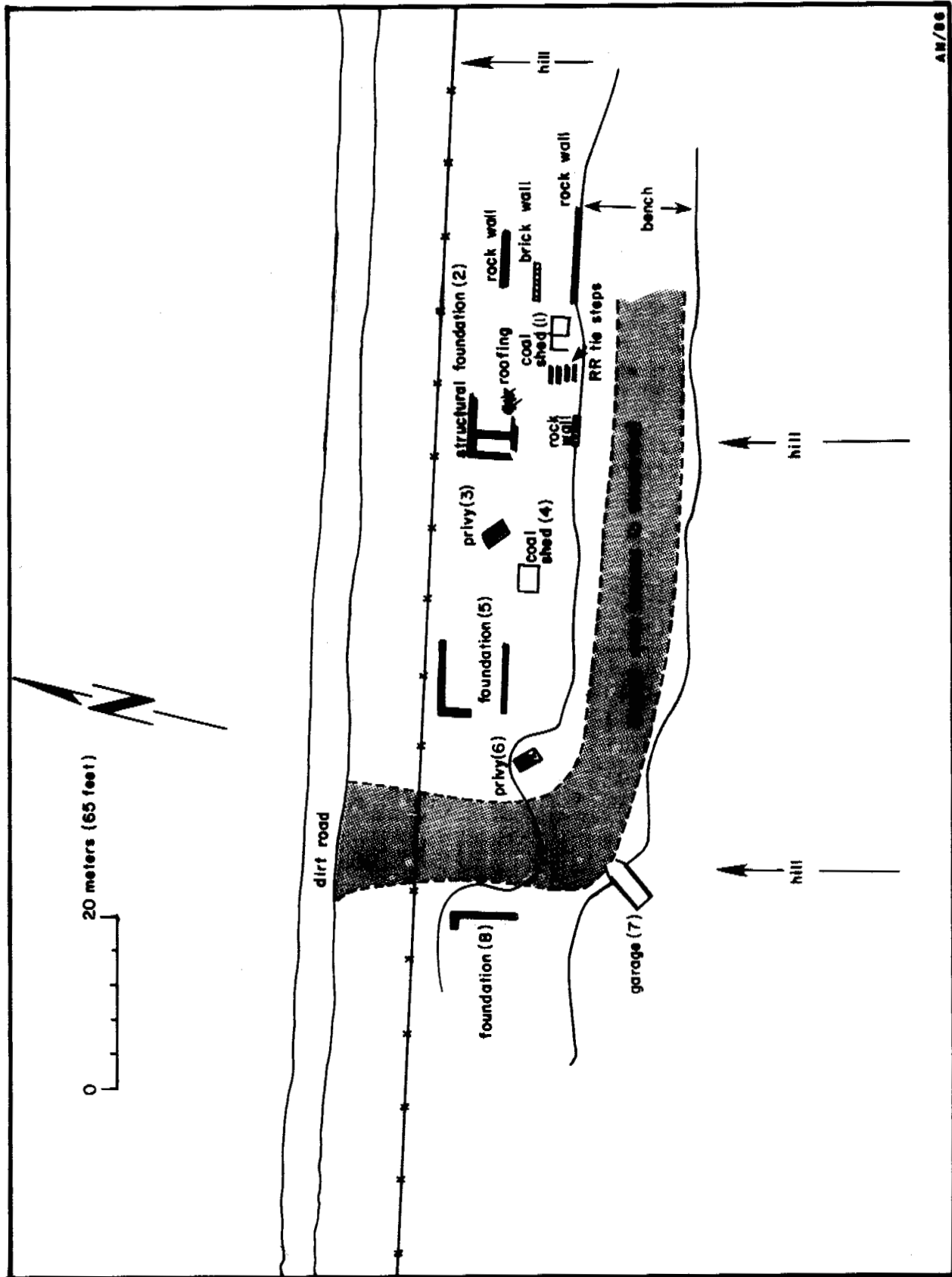


Figure 42. Plan view of RR 35, residential complex.

6 inch beams from a flat roof covered with tin remain on the building.

Structure #8 consists of another eroding rock foundation measuring 8.0 m in length.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to mechanically remove several of the collapsed structures at the site. Specifically, the two privies (Structures #3 and #6) and the possible garage (Structure #7) may be torn down in order to remove the numerous boards with protruding round nails from the area. Access to these structures has been archaeologically cleared (Fig. 42) through a 10.0 m wide path between them.



FIG. 43. Structure No. 7, garage at RR 35.

XV-Ox Canyon Mine (LA 57201)

Location: UTM Zone [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, 1959 to 1966.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: The Ox Canyon Mine is located on a bench on the slope of a steep hill reached by a single-lane dirt road. The site consists of two open adits, a power line, and a load-out (Fig. 44). Adit #1 is framed with steel beams. Notched timbered posts extend at least 30.0 m into the mine opening (Fig. 45). The entrance measures 6.0 m by 1.0 m. Thirty meters in front of Adit #1 on the edge of the bench is an opening to a load-out made of steel pipe, 1.2 m in diameter, which extends ca. 50.0 m downslope.

Adit #2 is also steel framed and is 15.0 m northwest of Adit #1. A date chalked on one of the beams reads 1-8-65. It is fronted by a concrete block fan house with a flat concrete roof (Fig. 46). The opening measures 3.4 by 2.1 m while the fan house measures 3.3 by 1.9 m. A steel door provides entry into the fan house. There is an air course on the southwest end of the fan which is covered with wire and metal pipe. Five meters southeast of Adit #2 is a concrete block powder house with a corrugated tin pitched roof. The structure measures 5.0 by 5.0 m and is 3.0 house.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to close the two adits of the Ox Canyon Mine. Adit #1 will be dynamited to close the entranceway. Adit #2 will receive a masonry closure. The powder house and load-out will not be affected by the closing of the adits. The bureau, however, may also elect to seal the opening of the metal load-out.

XVI-Potato Canyon Prospect

Location: UTM Zone [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Cultural/Temporal Affiliation: Historic, ca. 1893.

Ownership: Kaiser Steel Corporation.

Description: The Potato Canyon Prospect consists of a prospect hole dug into a sandstone bedrock cliff above a small stream 35.0 m south of the York Canyon Road. The opening is not framed, but appears to be cut with machinery. No artifacts or cultural material are located near the prospect.

The Abandoned Mine Land Bureau proposes to install a masonry closure across the 5.0 by 2.0 m opening. An access area of 35.0 by

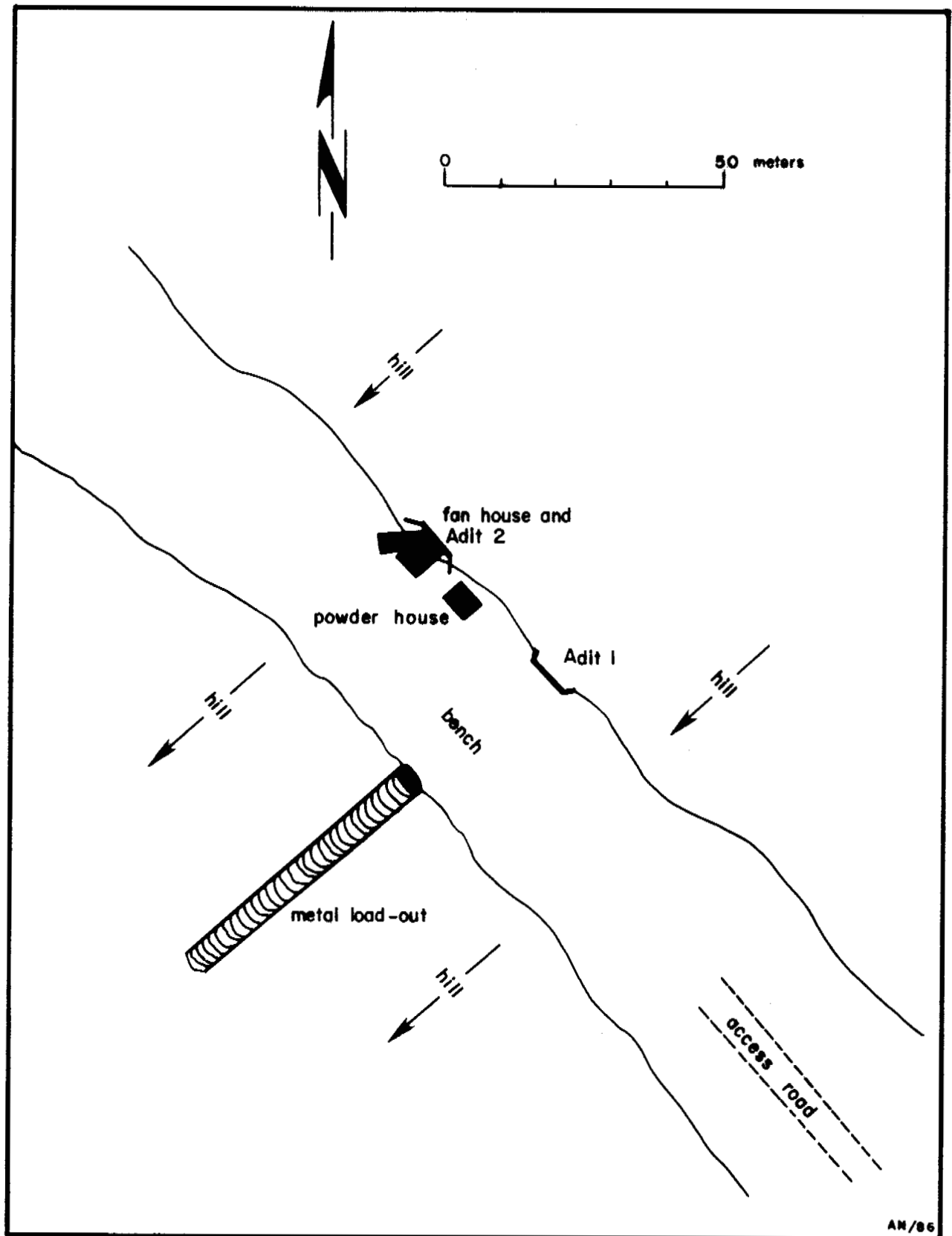


Figure 44. Plan view of Ox Canyon Mine.

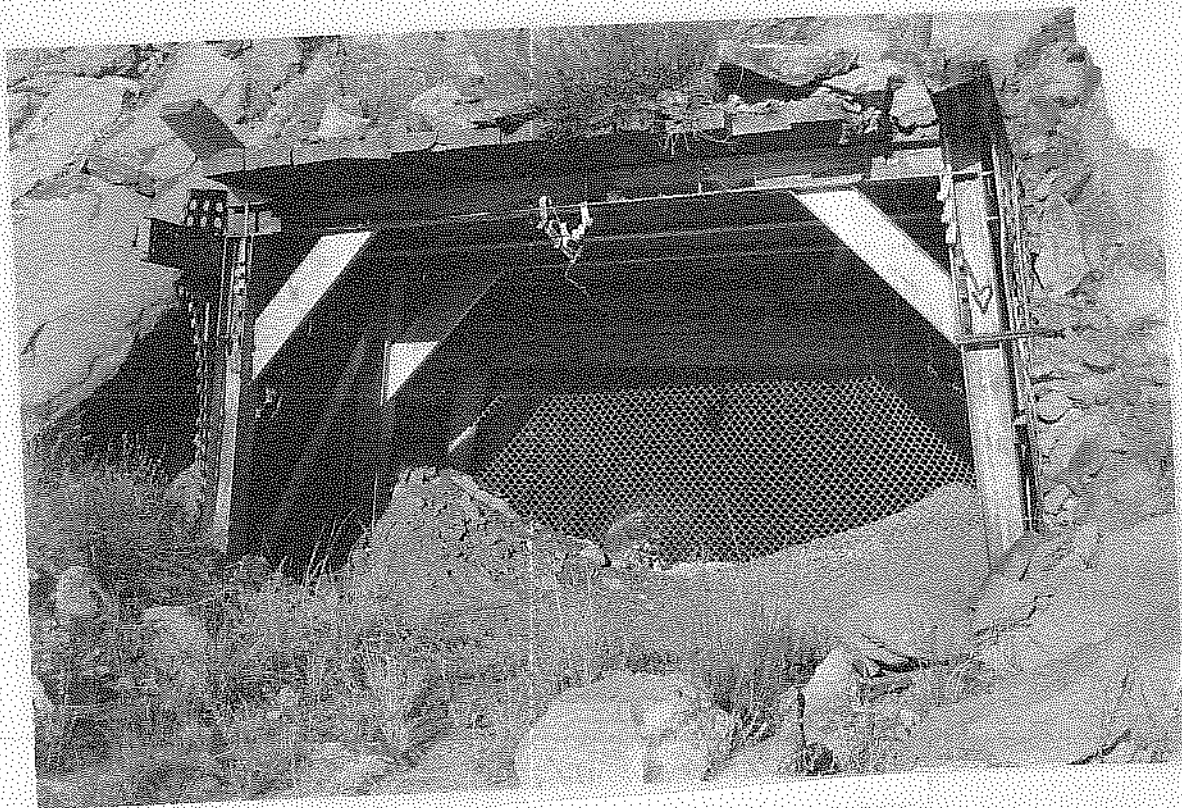


FIG. 45. Adit No. 2, Ox Canyon Mine.

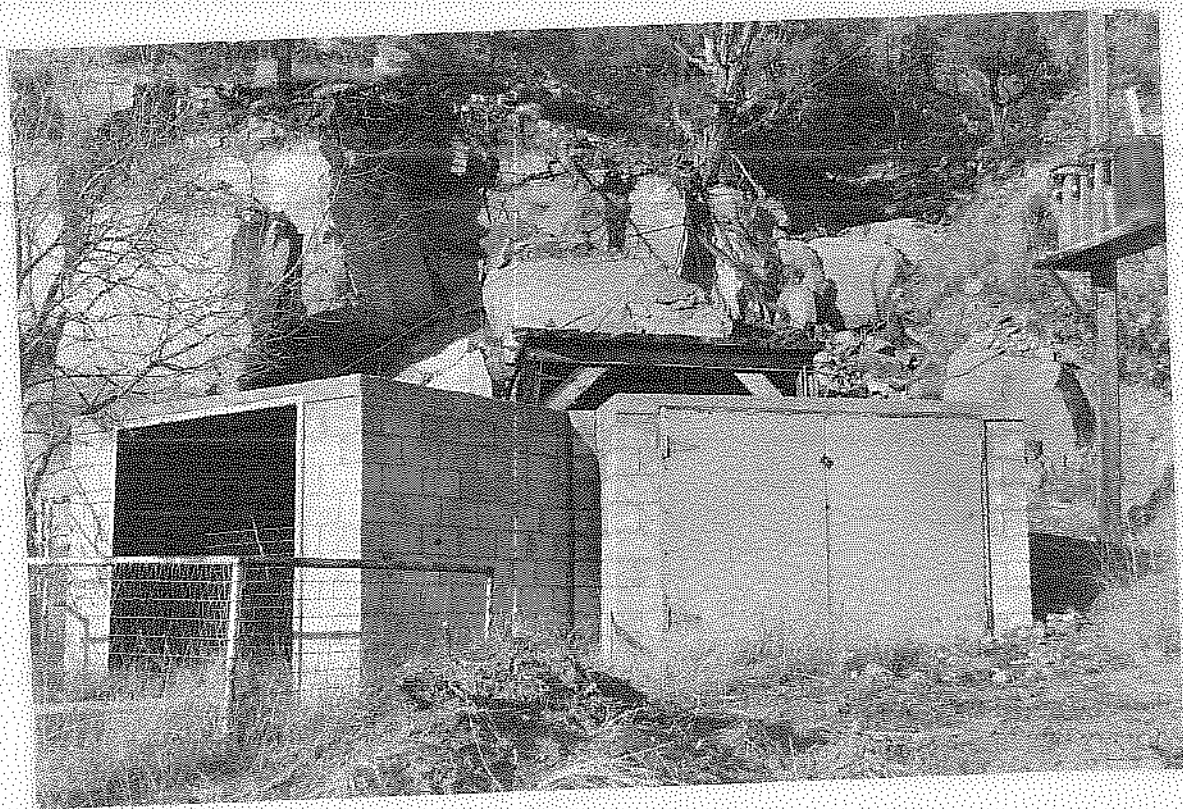


FIG. 46. Adit No. 1 and fan house, Ox Canyon Mine.

20.0 m between the prospect and York Canyon Road has been archaeologically cleared by Research Section personnel for vehicular access to the site.

MINING IN THE RATON COAL FIELD

The Raton Coal Field is the name commonly applied to the commercial coal beds at or near the base of the Vermejo formation in Colfax County (Bohor and Pillmore 1976:179). It covers approximately 2600 km and contains large reserves of high-quality coking coal. The coal field encompasses most of the Maxwell Land Grant established in 1841. Coal was probably first mined in the 1870s, prior to the construction of the Santa Fe Railway through Raton in 1879, by individual prospectors or small companies.

The mining of gold beginning in 1866, was the initial interest of the original land grant owners. As the practicality of retrieving gold diminished, the potential of the coal resource became apparent. By 1881, coal mining was a viable source of revenue on the grant. In the 1890s, the Raton Coal and Coke Co., organized by the Santa Fe Railway and officials of the Maxwell Land Grant Company, took over the coal mines (Oakes 1983:12). By 1900, there were many coal mines in operation in the area. Some closed after only a few years, others were periodically worked through the 1960s. A few, such as the York Canyon Mine, are still being worked today by the Kaiser Steel Corporation who owns much of the former Maxwell Land Grant.

Background data, where available, is provided below on the mines surveyed for this project.

I-Swastika No. 1 Mine. The mine opened prior to 1919 when a post office was established. Workings at the mine merged with the nearby Brilliant Mine in the 1920s. In 1929 the area had a population of 500 (Williams and McAllister 1979). By 1954, the post office was discontinued.

II-Blossburg Mines. There were at least four mines at Blossburg. No. 4 was the principal mine owned by the Santa Fe Railway and was open from 1882 to 1898 (Pillmore 1976:27). The community was established prior to 1881 when a post office opened. Blossburg was known as the "Pittsburgh of the West" and enjoyed boom status until the end of the century. Its population at that time was 1,000 (Williams and McAllister 1979). After that, it was gradually overshadowed by the Brilliant Mine. The post office was closed in 1905. All workings ceased by 1954.

III-Upper York Canyon Prospect. Available records state the York Canyon area was prospected as early as 1881 (Pearson 1961:82). No record of mine names was located.

IV to V-Luckini No. 1 Mine and Vellar Mine. These mines were first opened in approximately 1933. Louis Luckini became owner in 1934 and mined the properties until 1937 when it became known as the Chase Canyon Mine. In 1949 it was operated by the Rainy Coal Company under lease from the Chase Ranch. There are no records on the mine since 1950 (Nickelson papers).

VI-Roadside Adit. There is no information on when this adit was opened or who operated it.

VII-Genta Mine. E.R. Harvey prospected this mine in 1934 and gained a lease on it to January 25, 1935. He subsequently subleased it to William Lojek and Laurence Demchek in 1936. Lojek took over sole ownership in 1938 and hired 22 men to mine the coal. There was heavy mining activity up to 1941 and sporadic activity thereafter. The lease was assigned to Frank Genta in July, 1943. In 1967 the mine was sold to the four Sisneros brothers who hired one miner and operated the mine until May, 1970. At this time the leasees were cited for mining violations. Mining ceased in February, 1971. In 1976, the lease was assigned to Texas Industries, Inc., but no work has been done (Nickelson papers).

VIII to IX-Koehler Adits and Gob Pile. Mining in the Koehler area may have begun in the late nineteenth century. The town of Koehler, consisting of miners of diverse ethnic background, developed in approximately 1903 and soon experienced a boom in growth. In 1920 the population was 2,000 (William and McAllister 1979). A fire in 1923 leveled several buildings. The mine closed in 1924 with a population in the town of 1,200. The mine was reactivated in 1936 and produced coal on a limited scale. Permanent closure of the mines was in 1954.

X-Talbot Mine (LA 57191). The mine was first opened by T.E. Leonard in October, 1923, and subsequently operated by Luther I. Newton, until 1940. In 1940, it was sold to Tom Talbot and L.V. Hudson who operated it until 1948. The mine saw part-time use from 1948 to 1964. The lease was cancelled in July, 1965.

XI-Waldron Canyon Mine. There is no known available data on the Waldron Canyon Mine. Last date for workings at the site appear to be 1962.

XII-Dutchman Mine. The mine was reportedly opened in the early 1880s and closed by 1894 (Nickelson papers).

XIII-Yankee Mines. Mines in the area opened early in the twentieth century. The community of Yankee had a post office from 1906 to 1922. Population in 1915 was 300 persons (Williams and McAllister 1979). The mines were closed by approximately 1954 (Florin 1971).

XIV-Van Houten. Mining first began in the early twentieth century. Original development of the area was by the Raton Coal and Fuel Company and the mines were called the Willow Mines until ca. 1905 when they were renamed Van Houten. Between 1907 and 1908 the St. Louis Rocky Mountain and Pacific Company took over the mines. Coal from the mines was coked at Gardiner and Koehler. Many mines closed in 1924; some remained open until 1954.

XV-Ox Canyon Mine. The mine was opened by Kaiser Steel Corporation in 1959 and closed in 1966 (Nickelson papers).

CLEARANCE RECOMMENDATIONS

The current listing of the National Register of Historic Places and the New Mexico State Register of Cultural Properties have been consulted, and no sites listed on, nominated to, or approved for submission to either inventory are listed within the proposed project area.

Several cultural complexes encountered during the survey appear to be significant in terms of the eligibility criteria specified in 36 CFR 60 for the National Register of Historic Places. These include:

1. Blossburg (LA 57193)
2. Vellar Mine (LA 57194)
3. Koehler (LA 57196)
4. Van Houten (LA 57202)

The sites may be eligible to the National Register under criterion c as part of a significant and distinguishable entity whose components lack individual distinction. The mines and their associated mining communities are representative of early to mid twentieth century, coal mining operations New Mexico.

The other archaeological sites are architecturally non-distinctive, and lack any specific association with important persons or events in local or regional history, or the main workings post-date 1936. In addition, the potential of these remains to contribute new historical information by means of archival research, appears to be extremely limited. We believe that the information potential of these remaining sites has been exhausted by the current recording and research project.

Access to all sites is by existing dirt or paved roads. Areas surrounding these roads and all open terrain around cultural features were surveyed and existing cultural features mapped. In several cases (LA 57193, LA 57194, and LA 57202), access routes were strictly defined and appear on accompanying site maps.

We therefore recommend that cultural resources clearance be granted for the sealing of mine openings within the Raton coal field. Several structural remains are scheduled to be demolished by the Energy and Minerals Department, with concurrence of the Research Section archaeologist, because of the safety hazards they present to wildlife, domestic animals, and persons with access to the mine areas. These structural remains include:

1. Talbot Mine (LA 57197):
Remaining portion of the tippie
Mine owner's residence
Miner's shack

2. Van Houten (LA 57202)

Load-out

Tall corner (9 m) of brick screen plant

Two privies and garage at RR 35

We ask that when these structures are removed, no blading or bulldozing in the vicinity of the remains be done. Also, we ask that all other associated historical structures at the archaeological sites be strictly avoided during mine sealing work. We understand that the Abandoned Mine Land Bureau personnel will supervise all land disturbing activities, and will ensure that associated historic structures are not disturbed.

This report complies with the Secretary of the Interior's "Standards and Guidelines for Archaeology and Historic Preservation."

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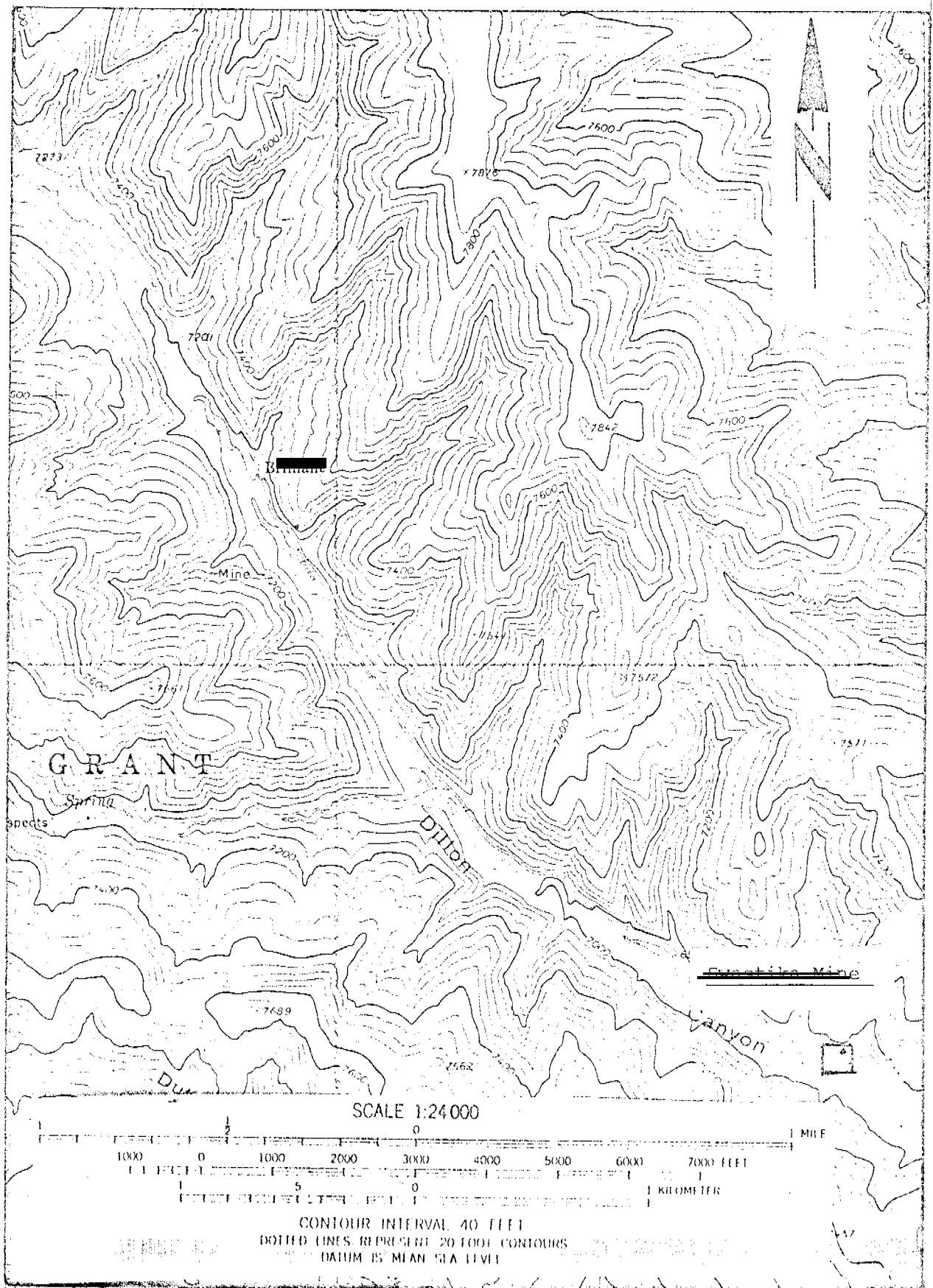
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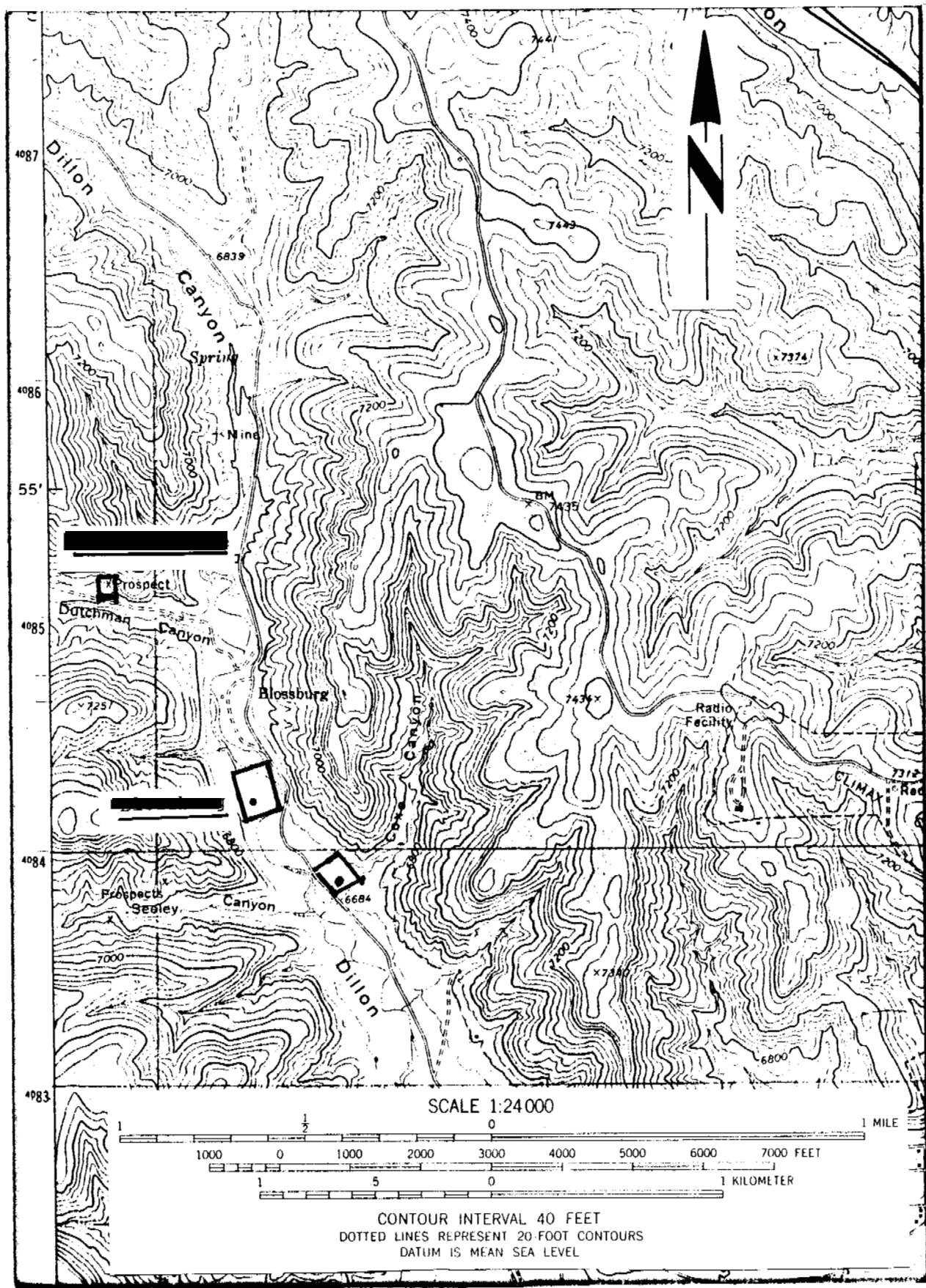
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Appendix: Maps of Surveyed Mine Areas



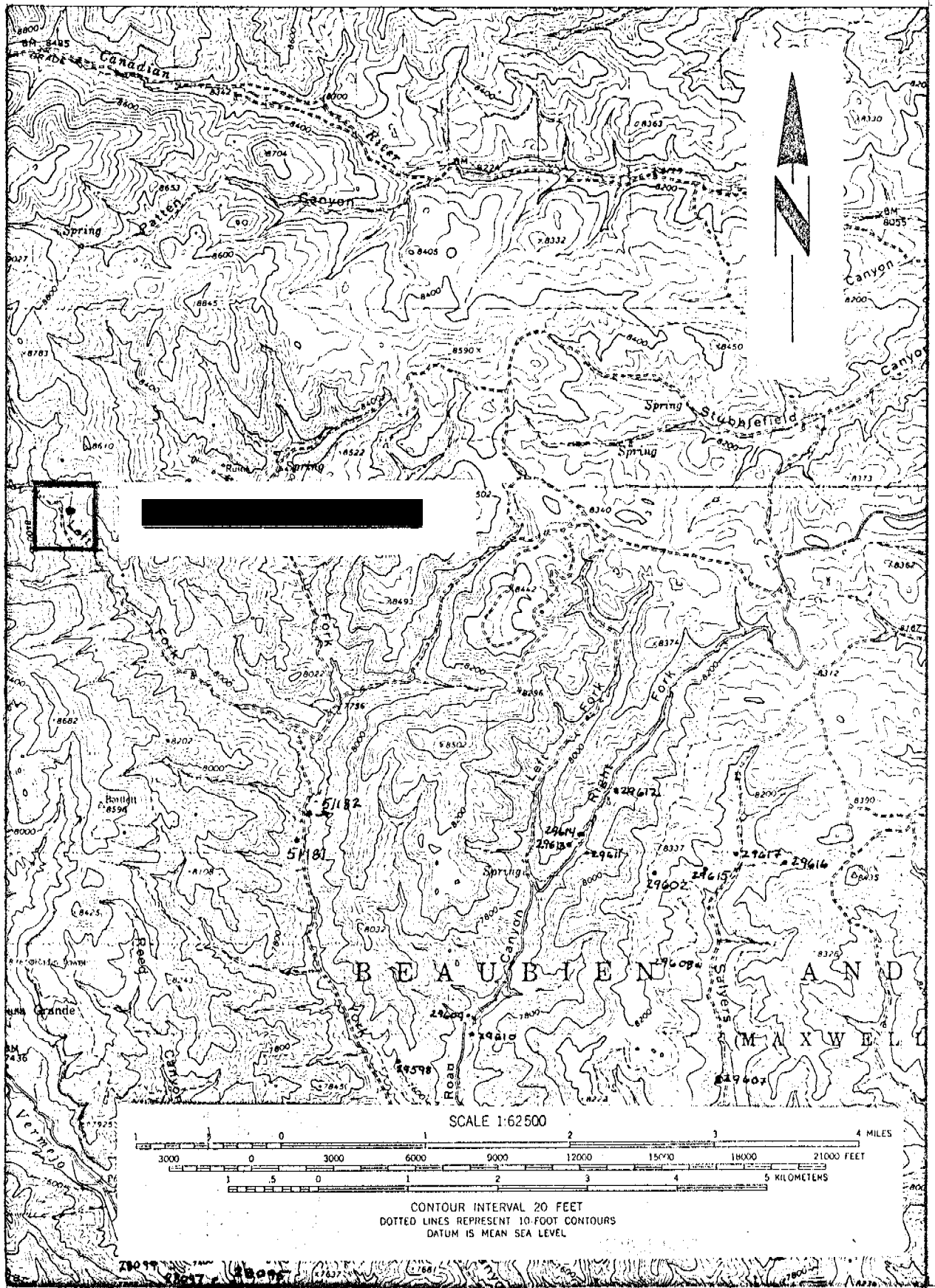
A. Swastika Mine

Tin Pan Canyon
1971



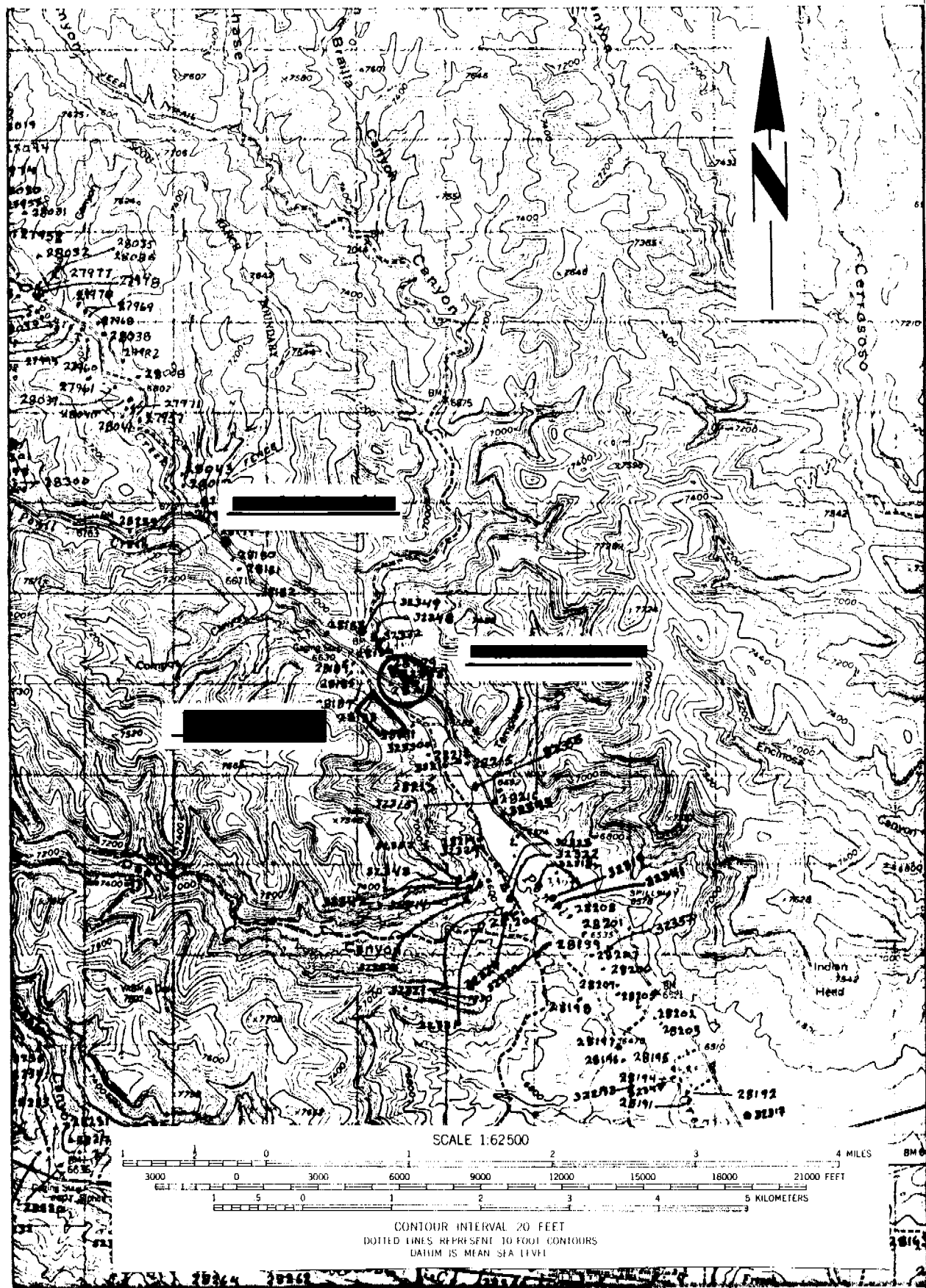
B. Blossburg and Dutchman Mines

Raton Quad
1971



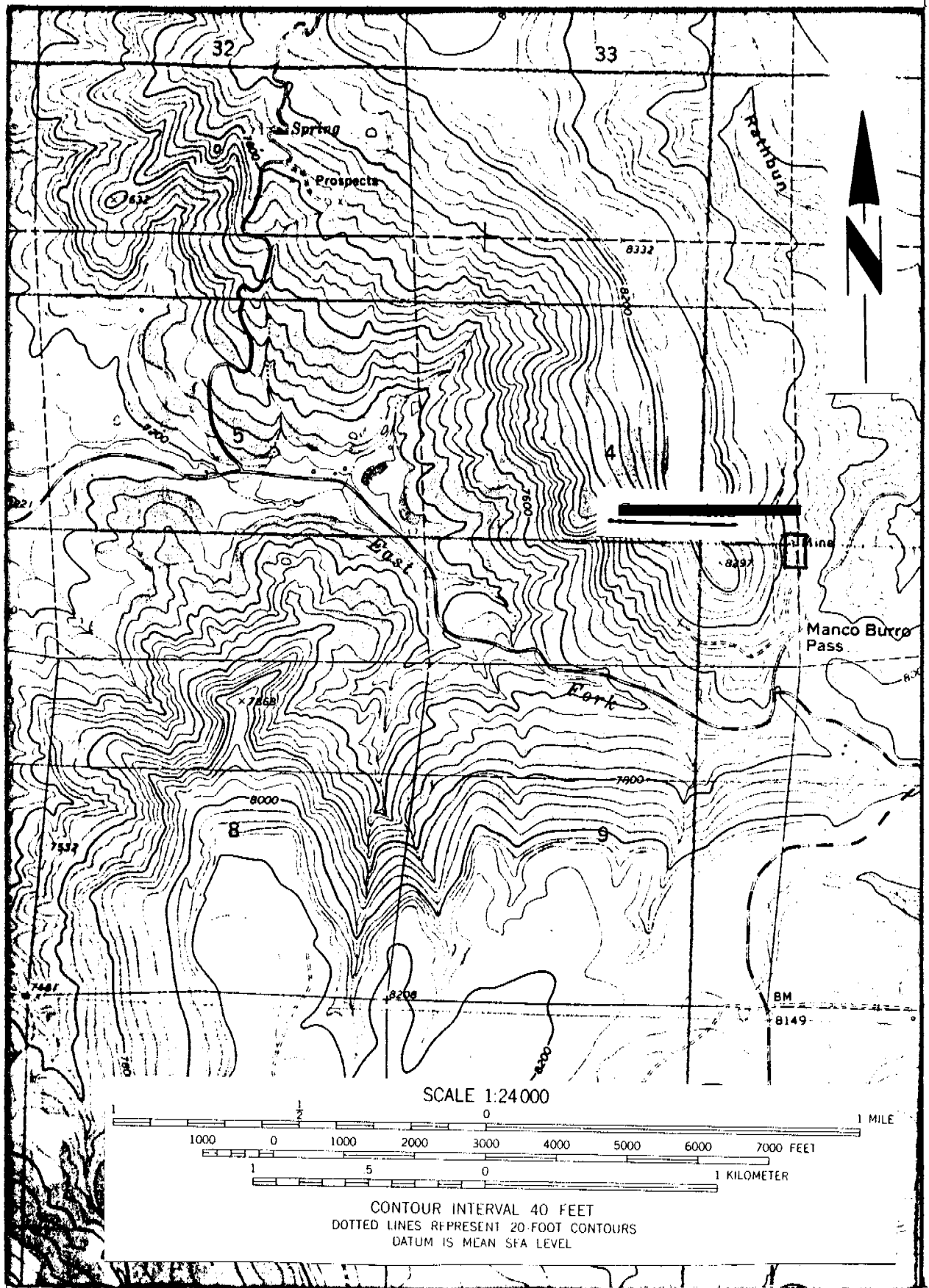
C. Upper York Canyon Mine

Casa Grande Quad
1962



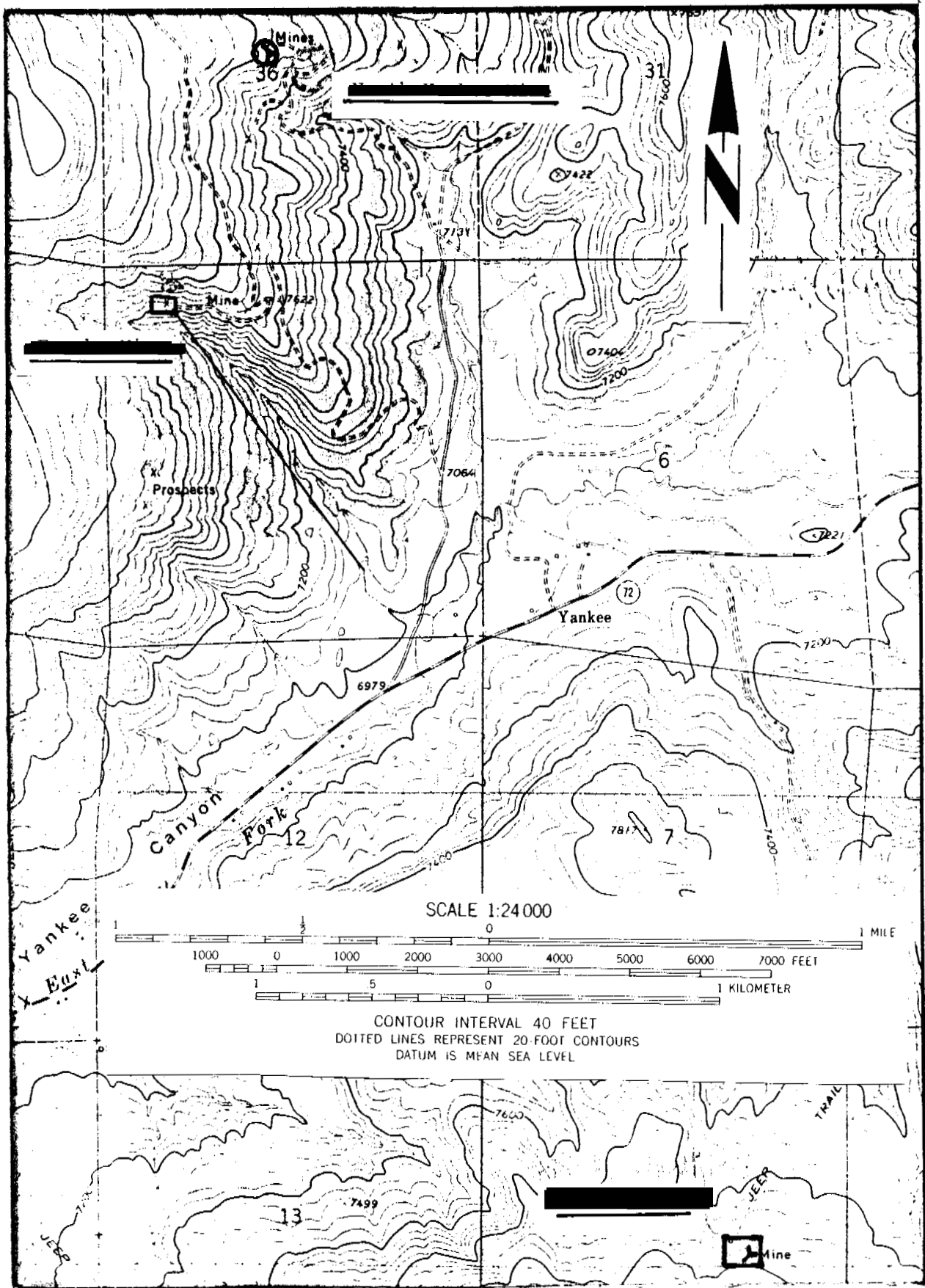
D. Vellar, Luckini and Roadside Mines

Cimarron Quad
1955



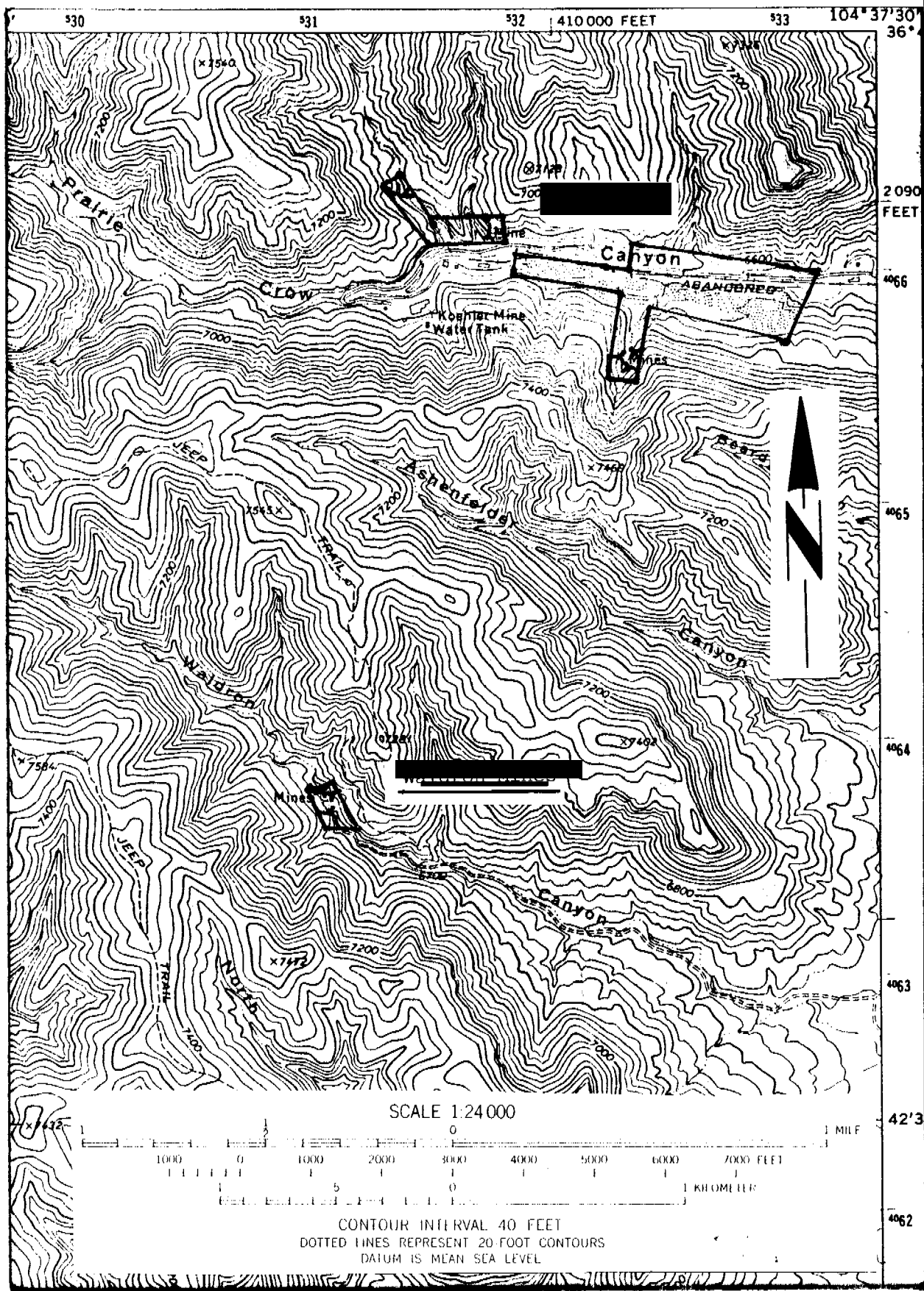
E. Genta Mine

Yankee Quad
1971



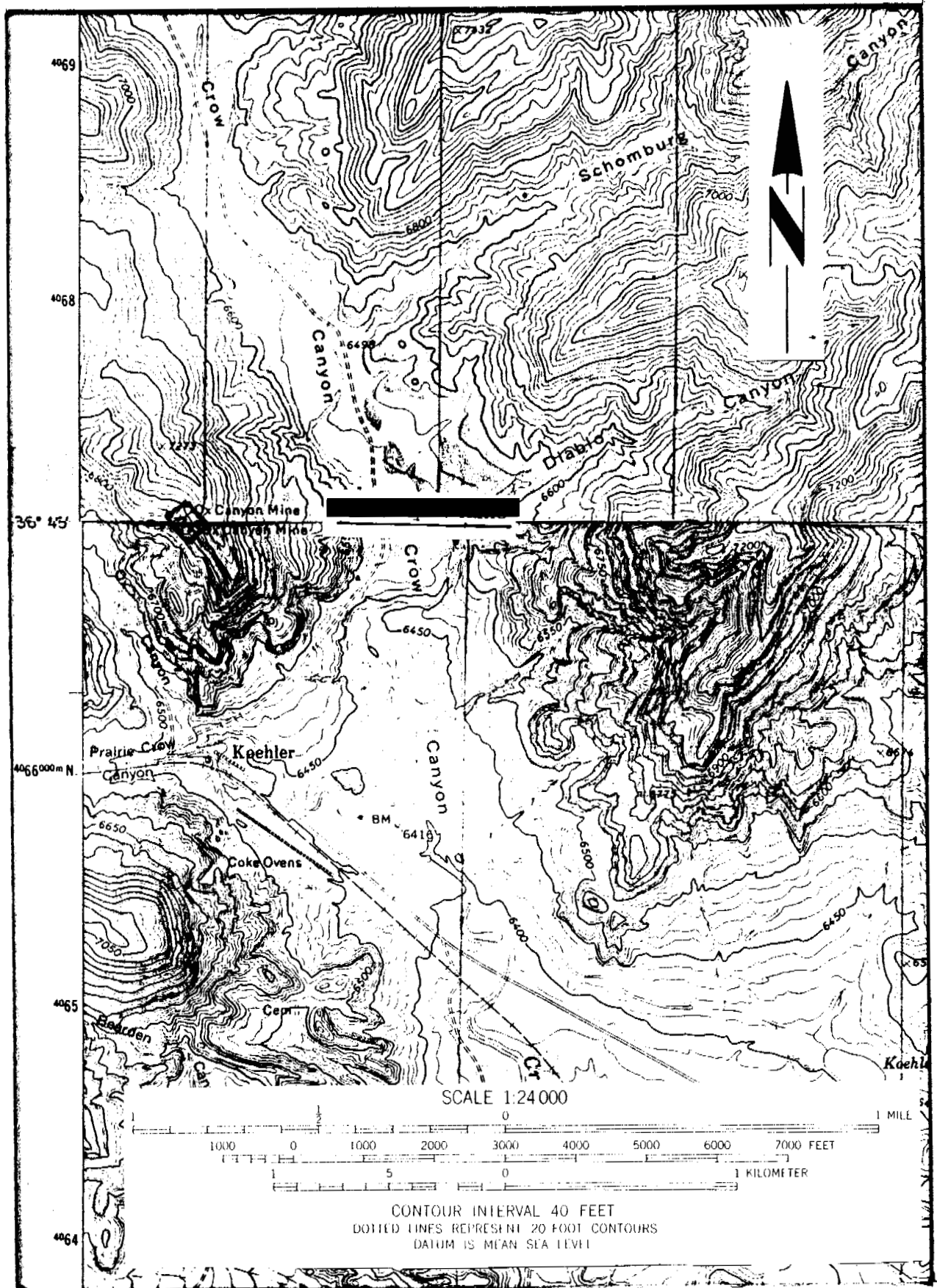
F. Talbot, Franks and North Yankee Mines

Yankee Quad
1971



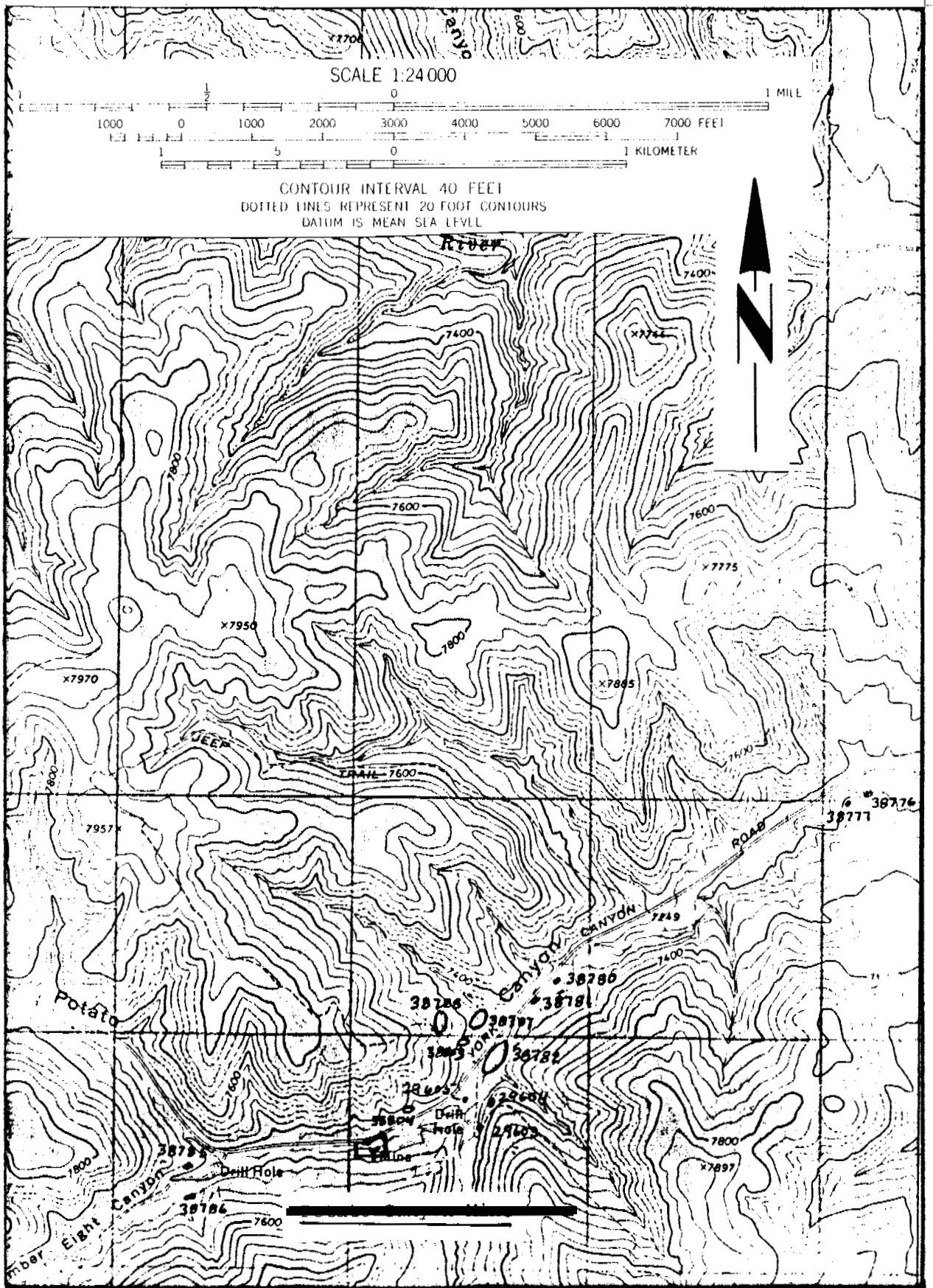
G. Koehler and Waldron Mines

Salt peter Mtn. Quad
1971



H. Ox Canyon Mine

Koehler & Red River Peak
Quads 1971



I. Potato Canyon Mine

McWilliams Quad
 1971